

# **Non-Invasive Blood Pressure Estimation Using Photoplethysmography and IoT-AI Integration**

## **Final Year Design Project**

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### **FINAL YEAR DESIGN PROJECT REPORT**

**This Report Presented in Partial Fulfillment of the  
Requirements for the Degree of Bachelor of Science in  
Computer Science and Engineering**

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**Dhaka, Bangladesh**

**September 9, 2025**

# APPROVAL

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This Project, titled “**Non-Invasive Blood Pressure Estimation Using Photoplethysmography and IoT-AI Integration**” submitted by Ridwan Sharif to the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Daffodil International University, has been accepted as satisfactory for the partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of B.Sc. in Computer Science and Engineering and approved as to its style and contents. The presentation has been held on [09-09-2025].

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# DECLARATION

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We hereby declare that this project has been done by us under the supervision of **Dr. Arif Mahmud, Associate Professor and Associate head**, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Daffodil International University. We also declare that neither this project nor any part of this project has been submitted elsewhere for the award of any degree or diploma.

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# ABSTRACT

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This study introduces the creation of a non-invasive, Internet of Things (IoT) blood pressure (BP)-monitoring measurement device, utilizing photoplethymography (PPS) signatures and machine learning models to determine systolic and diastolic blood pressure rates. The study objective was to develop a portable real-time BP monitoring solution, which can be able to provide constant monitoring, even in non-clinical settings. This IoT system will connect an ESP32 microcontroller and a MAX30102 PPG sensor, which are used to obtain PPG signals and process them with the help of different machine learning models to predict BP. A number of machine learning models have been trained and assessed with the help of the data obtained through the measurement of the IoT device such as Random Forest, AdaBoost, XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, and Bidirectional LSTM (BiLSTM). Random Forest model performed the best, having a Mean Absolute Error (MAE) of 9.08 and a R2 of 0.2416. Combination of Random Forest and AdaBoost (and other) as an ensemble method again increased the ability to predict, but did not allow the value of R2 to exceed 0.25, which is still lower than it could be, as there is space to improve it. The major limitations of this study were poor quality of PPG sensor and provided noisy measurements, and bias in data sample which was composed of mostly of young adults and men. Also, the lack of medical control over data collection influenced the quality of BP readings. Future work involves improving hardware to medical grade sensors, shrinking the gadget down to the size of a finger clip oximeter, and implementing deviations directly integrated on microcontrollers to do live inference. It opens a new way to innovate on the development of low-cost and non-invasive BP monitoring devices that have great potential to be improved further.

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# Chapter 1

## Introduction

This Chapter outlines the problem statement, the objective, the motivation and purpose of this research that is stated and the short outline of the methodology and how this report has been organized. Through this chapter the whole of the study can be glimpsed and primary understood.

### 1.1 Introduction

Hypertension, a persistently high blood pressure (BP), was a severe international health issue and the greatest modifiable cardiovascular (CVD) risk factor and is closely associated with myocardial infarction, stroke, heart failure, and chronic kidney disease.[1] It's largely being asymptomatic characteristic commonly allows its detection after the occurrence of a severe case, which makes hypertension to be referred to as the silent killer. The auscultatory or oscillometric sphygmomanometry, which is the current gold standard in the measurement of BP, has existed for more than 100 years, but they are just a point in time, episodic measure of hemodynamic status.[1] The gap in these intermittent measurements made in clinical settings is subject to the so-called white-coat hypertension effect, does not account for important determinants of BP variability, including nocturnal BP changes and post-awake BP spikes, and cannot comprehensively assess the range of BP variability.[3] In contrast, invasive arterial line monitoring provides continuous BP data that is critical to informing critical-care interventions, but it is too invasive (establishing an arterial cannula), and associated with infection and thrombosis risk, as well as patient discomfort, to be used routinely or in an ambulatory setting to profile patients.[2] Hypertension and other types of clinical deficits highlight the necessity of non-invasive and continuous BP monitoring technology, producing longitudinal and personalized data.[7]

In the current report, the design, methodological development, and initial assessment of a system that aims to fulfil this requirement via the combination of wearable sensors, the Internet of Things (IoT), and Artificial Intelligence (AI) will be outlined. The system consists of a wearable cuff device based on strain gauges and a central cloud-based analytics engine. The wearable unit measures beat-by-beat cuff deflection signal over a 24-hour wearing process, and all of the beat-by-beat signals are transmitted to the cloud engine to produce uninterrupted estimates in BP values and ensemble BP trends with the associated confidence intervals. These ensemble trajectories represent a time series of the whole picture of BP change that gives clinicians and patients a full longitudinal profile, which is a critical advance in the field of hypertension.

### 1.2 Motivation

The technological environment has become ready to resolve the issue of continuous and non-invasive monitoring of BP. The motivation behind this project is based on three technological pillars, namely: the omnipresence of wearable sensors, the

interconnectedness of the Internet of Things, and the analytical ability of Artificial Intelligence.

To start with, photoplethysmography (PPG) is one of the dominant sensing modalities in the consumer electronics market. PPG is a non-invasive, less expensive, and simple optical method to measure any volumetric change in blood in peripheral circulation.[6] Previously used for clinical pulse oximetry purposes only, PPG sensors have since then become the most common sensor found in practically endless wearable technology such as smartwatches and fitness trackers, offering real-time heart rate, heart rate variability, and blood oxygen saturation data.[9] The similarity between the waveform of the PPG and the arterial blood pressure gives evidence that information about BP is incorporated into the PPG signal, making it an excellent opportunity to retrieve this information.[11]

Second, the IoT (Internet of Things) can be used to provide the necessary framework to turn data captured by such wearable sensors into useful health analytics. The functionality of IoT architecture allows the smooth and secure gathering of real-time physiological data using individuals, which is wirelessly transferred to the cloud-based system to be stored and analyzed.[7] Such connectivity erases geographical boundary conditions, making it easy to conduct remote patient monitoring (RPM) and ensuring that healthcare providers monitor the health conditions of the patients without necessarily being at their locations, thus enhancing accessibility and cutting down the cost of healthcare delivery.[12]

Last, Artificial Intelligence (AI) is most useful, especially Machine Learning (ML) and Deep Learning (DL), the analytical engine needed to extract an understanding of the linear and non-linear relationship between the PPG signal, Demographic info and blood pressure. Whereas simpler approaches had to contend with signal noise and variations over time, sophisticated AI algorithms are now able to learn good representations directly off unprocessed signals, and automatically learn those hidden details that are predictive of BP fluctuations.[13] These three technologies, auspiciously combined by the term synergy, PPG (ubiquitous sensing), IoT (pervasive connectivity), and AI (intelligent analysis), form a very powerful, yet timely window of opportunity to devise a new solution to cuffless, continuous BP estimation.

### 1.3 Objectives

The current study aims at conceptualizing and reporting an end-to-end system of non-invasive blood pressure estimation that is both technologically valid and clinically applicable and in accordance with established engineering principles. The particular goals of the project are as follows:

1. To undertake a critical evaluation of the state-of-the-art in PPG-based

blood pressure measurement, evaluating methodology in Machine Learning (ML) and Deep Learning (DL).

2. To create an end-to-end system architecture of a non-invasive blood pressure monitoring system.
3. To explain the setup of a signal processing pipeline of PPG data and give a ML or DL model architecture that can be used to predict Systolic Blood Pressure (SBP) and Diastolic Blood Pressure (DBP) accurately using the processed PPG signal and Demographic data.

## 1.4 Methodology

The engineering requirements of this project will be achieved by a step-by-step, phase-oriented methodological framework that is very close to an orthodox medical device development path. The labor process begins with the stage of strict research and ends with the post-development audit.

1. Gap Analysis and Literature Review: To come up with a strong theoretical background, a systematic review of the available academic and industrial literature will be conducted. Existing PPG-based blood pressure estimators will be interrogated in this review by critically reviewing their advantages and limitations, and hence informing the design of the proposed system.
2. Architecture Design and System Requirements: The gap analysis will be used to build on the results, leading to a comprehensive set of functional and non-functional requirements being formulated. A multi-layered system architecture focused on IoT will be defined, where the hardware, software processing, and communication protocols of each layer will be specified.
3. Development and training of AI models: An appropriate AI architecture will be chosen and set up. It will be trained and tested on locally and privately collected data from the IoT device developed, where the simultaneous PPG, Demographic info and cuff-based Blood Pressure electrical machine provide a foundation on which to test.
4. Integrating and Implementing Prototypes: The approach to the development of a proof-of-concept prototype will be described, including the process of developing sensor hardware, developing a web interface application, and establishing cloud-based backend services and model deployment.
5. Comparison Analysis and Performance Assessment: An elaborate evaluation plan will be outlined. The performance of the systems will be quantitatively evaluated with various accuracy standards by using a special test set separated from the privately collected data set. Taken together, the metrics will be compared to the state of the art of the extant literature.

## 1.5 Project Outcome

The key output of this work is a well-crafted technical report on an expert level which serves as a complete blueprint of a non-invasive, PPG-based, IoT-AI, Web integrated blood pressure monitoring system. The report provides a hierarchical structure of how the system is designed down to physiological principles up to detailed structure of hardware, software and AI modules. It gives it a tough data-based evaluation of the system

performance against set clinical benchmark and a detailed review of compliance with key regulatory and engineering requirements.

## **1.6 Organization of the Report**

The current report is divided into six major parts so that the issue under consideration could be logically organized and covered thoroughly.

In chapter one introduction outlines the clinical imperative, the technological case, and the main project objectives. After that in chapter two background discusses the physiological basis of PPG, a literature review of the relevant literature concerning methods of estimating BP and relevant research gaps. In chapter three Research methodology, the presentation of the methodology is carried out in detail the architecture of the system, specifications of the design, the design of the AI model, and the project plan are discussed. Chapter four Implementation and Results, the environment of implementation is outlined, and the performance of the system is assessed; the meaning of the results is explained. Later in chapter five Engineering Standards and Design Challenges, The five themes that are discussed include compliance with engineering standards, implications to the wider society and its ethics, complexity of the engineering factors that are involved, and the engineering relationship of the system to the clinical practice. Finally in the last chapter, chapter six Conclusion, the most important results are stated, limitations of the project are mentioned, and the recommendations of prospective studies are provided.

# Chapter 2

## Background

The chapter offers essential background information, a preceding collection of precise investigations, a logical tabular representation of subsequent research, an evaluation of gaps, and a definitive conclusion. Through this chapter, the existing works and the innovation of this study can be preserved

### 2.1 Introduction

Firm consideration of the ability of photoplethysmography (PPG) to estimate blood pressure requires in-depth familiarity with the optical sensing technology as well as the physiological connection between the technique and the cardiovascular system. Photoplethysmography (PPG) is a non-invasive optical method aimed at the measurement of volume changes of blood in the microvascular bed of the tissue. The working principle is simple: a light-emitting diode (LED) shines on a part of the skin that may usually lie on the fingertip, earlobe, or wrist, and a photodetector detects the amount of incident light either passed through the tissue or reflected.[2]

Light passing through the biological tissues is absorbed by changeable elements such as the skeletal system, melanin, and blood. Most importantly, the most intense light-absorbing characteristics are in the blood. Due to the pulsatile flow of blood in the arteries, the amount of blood in the tissue that is being illuminated changes cyclically and is correlated to each heartbeat. This dynamic blood volume regulation results in opposite changes in the light absorption in tissue, and this has been registered in the form of a photoplethysmography (PPG) waveform.[6]

The PPG waveform shows two major components. The direct current (DC) component is made up of the dominant, slowly varying component, which is a reflection of the constant baseline tissue, bone, and non-pulsatile venous blood absorption of light. On top of this baseline is a far smaller AC component that is heart-synchronized and explains the pulsatile changes in arterial blood volume. The morphological data that is most relevant to cardiovascular dynamics can be found in the AC component, not the DC component. Despite morphological similarities between the photoplethysmography(PPG) waveform and the arterial blood pressure (ABP) waveform measured by an invasive catheter, the two are different physical quantities: PPG measures the change in blood volume, whereas ABP pressure. However, since the distension of the arterial walls and consequently the blood volume relies precisely on the pressure wave that travels through the arterial tree, PPG is a useful surrogate that contains embedded information about blood pressure.[11]

### 2.2 Literature Review

BP measurement is a critical diagnostic/prognostic indicator of cardiovascular health. Conventional systems, however, require the use of cuffs, which are usually fitted on the upper arm, and they are intrusive and uncomfortable. Genuine, cuffless methods have hence formed an active research field over the past number of decades. The review follows the history of cuffless blood pressure measurement

methodology, distinguishing between three consecutive generations of methodologies: methods based on pulse transit time, traditional machine learning models using hand-designed features, and the latest paradigm based on machine learning.

Table 2.1: Summary of Literature Reviewed.

| Author(s)         | Year | Title                                                                                                                                                      | Methodology                                                                        | Key Findings                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dai, D. et al.    | 2024 | Non-Invasive Continuous Blood Pressure Estimation from Single-Channel PPG Based on a Temporal Convolutional Network Integrated with an Attention Mechanism | TCN with Convolutional Block Attention Module (CBAM) on the UCI dataset.           | DBP estimation met the AAMI standard (MAE 2.12 mmHg); SBP did not (MAE 5.35 mmHg). TCN-CBAM outperformed other ML/DL models.                                   |
| Tarifi, B. et al. | 2023 | A Machine Learning Approach to the Non-Invasive Estimation of Continuous Blood Pressure Using Photoplethysmography                                         | Four neural networks for SBP, DBP, MAP, and waveform prediction on MIMIC-III data. | SBP (MAE 5.26 mmHg) and DBP (MAE 2.96 mmHg) results met international standards. Novel separation of discrete value prediction from waveform shape prediction. |

|                       |      |                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Wong, M. K. F. et al. | 2023 | Applied machine learning for blood pressure estimation using a small, real-world electrocardiogram and photoplethysmogram dataset | Compared RF, SVR, Adaboost, and ANN on a small, noisy dataset (n=54) using ECG+PPG features.  | SVR performed best on noisy data (MAE 6.97 mmHg), meeting BHS Level C criteria. Demonstrated feasibility on real-world ambulatory data.  |
| Mohammadi, H. et al.  | 2025 | Cuff-less blood pressure monitoring via PPG signals using a hybrid CNN-BiLSTM deep learning model with an attention mechanism     | Hybrid CNN-BiLSTM with attention mechanism on a large MIMIC-II dataset (2064 patients).       | Achieved very high accuracy with MAE of 1.88 mmHg for SBP and 1.34 mmHg for DBP, underscoring potential for scalable wearable solutions. |
| Wang, W. et al.       | 2021 | Cuff-Less Blood Pressure Estimation via Small Convolutional Neural Networks                                                       | Modified LeNet-5 CNN trained on images created from PPG segments using Visibility Graph (VG). | Achieved Grade A under BHS protocol for both SBP (ME 0.18±7.46 mmHg) and DBP (ME 0.34±4.07 mmHg).                                        |



|                   |      |                                                                                              |                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Brophy, E. et al. | 2021 | Estimation of Continuous Blood Pressure from PPG via a Federated Learning Approach           | Time-series-to-time-series GAN (T2T-GAN) with a federated learning approach for privacy.     | Successfully modeled continuous ABP from PPG. Achieved MAP error of 2.95 mmHg after calibration. Showcased a privacy-preserving, scalable solution. |
| Li, Z. & He, W.   | 2021 | A Continuous Blood Pressure Estimation Method Using Photoplethysmography by GRNN-Based Model | Generalized Regression Neural Network (GRNN) using harmonics of the raw PPG signal as input. | Fulfilled AAMI and BHS Grade A standards (MAE 3.96 mmHg SBP, 2.39 mmHg DBP). Computationally efficient and can estimate the full BP waveform.       |

|                        |      |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chowdhury, M.H. et al. | 2020 | Estimating Blood Pressure from the Photoplethysmogram Signal and Demographic Features Using Machine Learning Techniques | Gaussian Process Regression (GPR) with 107 extracted features (demographic, time/frequency domain, statistical). | GPR with ReliefF feature selection yielded high accuracy (RMSE 6.74 SBP, 3.59 DBP). Complied with BHS Grade B.                                                                 |
| Slapničar, G. et al.   | 2019 | Blood Pressure Estimation from Photoplethysmogram Using a Spectro-Temporal Deep Neural Network                          | Custom ResNet architecture using 5s PPG waveform and its derivatives as input.                                   | MAEs of 9.4 mmHg (SBP) and 6.9 mmHg (DBP) did not meet clinical standards, but the work was a valuable guide due to its large dataset (510 patients) and detailed methodology. |

|                     |      |                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                          |
|---------------------|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Kurylyak, Y. et al. | 2013 | A Neural Network-based method for continuous blood pressure estimation from a PPG signal          | An Artificial Neural Network (ANN) was trained on 21 manually extracted parameters from PPG signals in the MIMIC database. | Proved more precise than linear regression methods, achieving MAEs of 3.8 mmHg (SBP) and 2.2 mmHg (DBP). |
| Liu, M. et al.      | 2017 | Cuffless blood pressure estimation based on photoplethysmography signal and its second derivative | SVM model using 14 new features from the second derivative of PPG (SDPPG) combined with 21 conventional features.          | Enhanced BP estimation accuracy by 40% compared to Kurylyak et al.'s approach.                           |
| Xing, X. & Sun, M.  | 2016 | Optical blood pressure estimation with photoplethysmography and FFT-based neural networks         | ANN trained on FFT-derived features (amplitudes, phases) from normalized PPG signals.                                      | Fulfilled BHS protocol, ranking Grade A/A. Fast and robust method using only PPG.                        |

|                     |      |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Kachuee, M. et al.  | 2017 | Cuffless Blood Pressure Estimation Algorithms for Continuous Health-Care Monitoring                                                                       | Algorithm based on Pulse Arrival Time (PAT) and other features from vital signals, using regression models.                  | Complied with the AAMI standard for DBP and MAP. Achieved BHS Grade A for DBP and Grade B for MAP.                                       |
| Dey, J. et al.      | 2018 | InstaBP: Cuff-less blood pressure monitoring on a smartphone using a single PPG sensor                                                                    | Ensemble of prediction models based on demographic/physiological partitioning, using unique PPG features on a smartphone.    | Achieved MAE of 5 mmHg (DBP) and 6.9 mmHg (SBP), an 18% and 11.5% improvement over ubiquitous models, respectively.                      |
| Tjahjadi, H. et al. | 2020 | Noninvasive Classification of Blood Pressure Based on Photoplethysmography Signals Using Bidirectional Long Short-Term Memory and Time-Frequency Analysis | BLSTM network trained on time-frequency features (instantaneous frequency, spectral entropy) from PPG for BP classification. | Achieved high classification accuracy (97.33%), sensitivity (100%), and specificity (94.87%), outperforming CNN, KNN, and other methods. |

|                 |      |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chen, S. et al. | 2019 | A Non-Invasive Continuous Blood Pressure Estimation Approach Based on Machine Learning                | SVR model optimized with a Genetic Algorithm (GA), using 14 features from ECG and PPG (including PTT and waveform characteristics). | High accuracy (error $3.27 \pm 5.52$ mmHg SBP, $1.16 \pm 1.97$ mmHg DBP), meeting AAMI and BHS Grade A criteria.                              |
| Liu, Z. et al.  | 2020 | Continuous Blood Pressure Estimation From Electrocardiogram and Photoplethysmogram During Arrhythmias | Random Forest Regression (RFR) model using 15 features from ECG and PPG to estimate BP during arrhythmias.                          | RFR model performed best, meeting AAMI and BHS Grade A standards even in arrhythmia patients (ME - $0.04 \pm 6.11$ SBP, $0.11 \pm 3.62$ DBP). |

|                                               |      |                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Argüello-Prada, E.J. & Castaño Mosquera, C.D. | 2024 | Exploring supervised machine learning models to estimate blood pressure using non-fiducial features of the photoplethysmogram (PPG) and its derivatives | GPR models combined with ReliefF feature selection using 57 non-fiducial features (statistical indexes, energy operators).       | GPR models provided excellent predictions (RMSE < 0.8 mmHg for SBP, < 0.7 mmHg for DBP) using only 15 non-fiducial features, suitable for computationally constrained hardware. |
| Chandrasekhar, A. et al.                      | 2020 | PPG Sensor Contact Pressure Should Be Taken Into Account for Cuff-Less Blood Pressure Measurement                                                       | Experimental study on 17 subjects varying PPG sensor contact pressure (CP) and measuring its impact on Pulse Arrival Time (PAT). | PAT deviations due to CP changes can translate to BP errors of 11-20 mmHg, highlighting a critical, often overlooked, confounding variable in cuffless BP measurement.          |

|                        |      |                                                                                                 |                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chakraborty, A. et al. | 2020 | PPG-based automated estimation of blood pressure using patient-specific neural network modeling | Patient-specific Neural Network (NN) models using 4 selected time-plane PPG features.           | Patient-specific approach eliminates need for correction factors, achieving high accuracy (mean error $0.46 \pm 2.63$ mmHg SBP, $0.15 \pm 1.48$ mmHg DBP).           |
| Li, Y. et al.          | 2020 | Real-Time Cuffless Continuous Blood Pressure Estimation Using Deep Learning Model               | Deep learning regression models using ECG and PPG for real-time SBP and DBP estimation.         | The proposed model outperformed existing methods and achieved accurate estimation.                                                                                   |
| Zadi, A.S. et al.      | 2018 | Arterial Blood Pressure Feature Estimation Using Photoplethysmography                           | Fifth-order autoregressive moving average (ARMA) models to relate PPG peaks/troughs to SBP/DBP. | ARMA models effectively tracked BP trends with low model errors ( $<5$ mmHg during normal breathing, $<8$ mmHg during breath-hold), comparable to PTT-based methods. |

### 2.2.1 Similar Applications

#### Pulse Transit Time (PTT) and Pulse Wave Velocity (PWV) Early Methods

The oldest and most developed principle of cuffless BP estimation is connected to the relation of arterial stiffness and the velocity of the pressure wave moving along the arteries. This speed is referred to as Pulse Wave Velocity (PWV). The Moens-Korteweg equation gives the theoretical basis, correlating PWV with the elasticity of the arterial wall which is in turn dependent on blood pressure.[2] Greater blood pressure is normally equivalent to a more rigid vasculature, which leads to a quicker PWV.

Measuring PWV directly is complicated, and therefore, a proxy is almost always taken, in the form of Pulse Transit Time (PTT). PTT is the period required for the arterial pressure wave to travel between two different sites of the body.[20] Two signals are needed to determine PTT: a proximal signal denoting when a cardiac cycle begins and a distal signal denoting when the pulse wave has reached a peripheral site. R-wave of an electrocardiogram (ECG) is most frequently used as the proximal timing reference, whereas a foot or peak of a PPG waveform of a fingertip or a wrist is used as the distal reference.[15] The delay between the ECG R-wave and the PPG feature is technically called the Pulse Arrival Time (PAT), the sum of the PTT and the pre-ejection period (PEP)-the electromechanical delay of the heart.[21] PAT is a convenient in vivo substitute for PTT in a large number of studies.[22]

Although PTT-based approaches have a good physiological foundation and have shown reasonable accuracy in laboratory environments, their main drawback is the fact that they necessitate the use of two distinct sensors (ECG and PPG).[5] This adds to the complexity of hardware, form factor, and power of a wearable device and makes it impractical to monitor over a long period of time and in an unobtrusive manner. It is this inherent limitation that has been a major driver in the formulation of approaches that can estimate BP solely on the basis of a single PPG sensor.[4]

#### PWA or Feature-Based Machine Learning

The subsequent generations of algorithms attempted to do away with the requirement of having an ECG signal and use the morphology of the PPG waveform alone. Such a method is referred to as Pulse Wave Analysis (PWA) and is based on the fact that the profile of the PPG wave carries enough information to deduce blood pressure.[16] In this "classical" machine learning paradigm, the first step is a meticulous process of manual feature engineering. It is possible to notice dozens of features identified and extracted by researchers in the PPG signal and its 1st and 2nd derivatives (the velocity and acceleration plethysmograms, VPG and APG, respectively).[15]

These features are designed to quantify various aspects of the waveform's morphology. Time-domain characteristics are durations of systolic upstroke, diastolic and pulse width at various percentages of pulse height.[15] The heights of systolic and diastolic peaks are recorded by amplitude-based features. Other characteristics are based on the places and amplitudes of typical points on the VPG and APG, e.g., the dicrotic notch, which is a reflection of the valve closure of the aortic valve.[19] After this complete feature set is obtained, it is fed as input to conventional machine learning regression models, including Linear Regression, Support Vector Machines (SVM), AdaBoost, and Random Forests, which are trained to convert the feature vectors into the SBP and DBP values.[15]



Although feature-based techniques were effective in the sense that they proved the principle that BP could be estimated with a single sensor, they have a severe weakness in that they are sensitive to the detection of fiducial points (peaks, valleys, notches) on the waveform. In practice, PPG signals measured with wearable devices often contain motion artifacts and noise, which may severely alter the morphology of the signal and render the accurate determination of these important points practically impossible and, at best, very challenging.[15] This fundamental weakness with respect to noisy data has led the field to more data-driven, robust methods.

## **Deep Learning Renaissance**

Advancements in cuffless BP measurement have been driven by the recent and most promising success of deep learning. Unlike classical machine learning, deep learning models may perform end-to-end learning, i.e., can automatically learn pertinent features out of raw or minimally processed signal data, thus bypassing the brittle, hand-designed feature extraction[15]. This feature causes them to be more resistant by default to the signal distortion and artifacts that can be expected in wearable sensor data.

Many deep learning architectures have been utilized on this issue. CNNs excel in learning spatial hierarchies of features of signal segments themselves, and they are treated as one-dimensional images[15]. Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs), and more recently developed extensions, such as the Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks and Gated Recurrent Units (GRUs), are intended to capture temporal structure in sequential data, which makes them particularly appropriate in the study of time-series signals, such as PPG.[24] More recently, hybrid architecture consisting of the advantages of both of them, like the CNN-LSTM models, have performed well by employing CNN layers to extract features and LSTM layers to learn temporal dependencies[24].

Temporal Convolutional Networks (TCNs) are another architectural innovation, employing dilated convolutions and causal convolutions to learn long-range temporal patterns with greater efficiency than is done using traditional RNNs[14]. Also, these networks have incorporated attention mechanisms. The model can dynamically reweight the relevance of various components of the input signal and is essentially learning to pay attention to the most informative segments of the PPG waveform and disregard the noisy or irrelevant components, which makes the model even more robust and accurate[15]. These deep learning methods are now the state-of-the-art and everywhere they have been found to outperform their feature-based counterparts, at least on large-scale public datasets[15].

## **IoT in Remote Patient Monitoring**

Creating a good BP estimation AI model is just one step of a fully fledged remote monitoring solution. The Internet of Things (IoT) will offer the necessary infrastructure linking the wearable sensor to the end-user and healthcare provider. A typical architecture of an IoT healthcare is made of multiple layers[13]. The wearable sensors take the physiological data, and they are also perceived as the perception layer. Data transmission is the task of the network layer; typically, low-power wireless protocols like Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) are used to transmit the data between the sensor and a local gateway device, typically a smartphone[8]. The gateway will then have the data relayed via Wi-Fi or cellular to the cloud.

Lightweight protocols such as MQTT (Message Queuing Telemetry Transport) are commonly used to communicate between the gateway and the cloud because of their ability to manage data of many devices over possibly unreliable networks. The application layer is on the cloud, where it includes data storage, the AI-driven analysis engine, and front-end applications (e.g., a mobile app dashboard)[7]. The most important aspect of such systems is end-to-end security. This is done by encrypting data on the fly, such as the Transport Layer Security (TLS) protocol, authentication of devices and users, and strong access control policies on the cloud platform to defend sensitive health data. These IoT principles are essential to the development of a remote BP monitoring system that can be scaled, secure, and easy to use.

## 2.3 Gap Analysis

A critical literature review indicates that the examined literature has identified a number of challenges and gaps that cannot be ignored in order to facilitate the implementation of cuffless blood pressure monitoring technologies in clinical practice. The proposed project is mainly concerned with addressing these gaps.

- I. **The Calibration Conundrum:** A large majority of current cuffless BP estimation algorithms, even most commercial ones, are not calibration-free. They need regularly to be calibrated against a standard cuff-manometer sphygmomanometer on an individual user basis, typically weekly or monthly.[23]This is a basic shortcoming since this negates the main value position of a completely seamless and non-obtrusive monitoring experience. It reintroduces the very device that the technology aims to replace, creating a burden for the user and limiting the system's autonomy. These devices are thus not meant to provide absolute BP but to monitor the change of BP in comparison with the previous calibration. The development of robust, calibration-free methods remains a "holy grail" in the field, with recent research exploring the use of PPG morphology and cardiovascular dynamics as a potential replacement for cuff-based calibration[11].
- II. **Inadequate Strength of Validation and Standardization:** Research in these areas is full of research that shows high accuracy, but most such claims are based on flimsy grounds. One of the largest gaps arises out of the common application of poor testing protocols and a lack of any universally accepted method of validation for cuffless devices, in particular.[1]The typical problems are the validations on small, homogeneous datasets (e.g., only young healthy subjects), which do not allow generalizing, and the subtle data leakage, where the test set information finds its way into the training or selection of the model thus inflating the reported performance results.[1]Where cuff-based devices have standards such as AAMI, BHS, the latter are complicated and can be misleading when applied to cuff-calibrated cuffless devices. The research community and regulatory authorities must urgently come up with a stringent validation framework, which is standardized and specific to the nature of these new technologies.
- III. **Generalizability and Motion Artifacts:** The difference between lab and real life in performance is large. The majority of AI models are trained over broadly large datasets such as MIMIC, which have comparatively clean signals of patients in ICUs under reclining conditions.[15]When such models are used on

wearable devices in ambulatory settings, the accuracy of the models becomes considerably poorer as they are contaminated by the motion artifacts.[15]The PPG waveform can be severely distorted by physical activity, poor sensor-skin contact and pressure variations in the contact pressure, making feature extraction or model inference unreliable. Finding algorithms that are naturally robust to that noise, or that can reliably utilize data collected by ancillary sensors, including accelerometers, to detect and correct motion-contaminated portions, is an engineering challenge of vital importance and that is not yet solved.[10]

- IV. **Combination of Physiological and Clinical Data:** Blood pressure is a multifactorial physiological parameter that is subject to an enormous number of influencing factors that are not reflected in the PPG waveform alone, such as age, gender and body mass index (BMI), and presence of comorbidities. Nonetheless, most of the literature reports solely consider signal processing and machine learning on the PPG signal alone. The studies that successfully combine these important clinical and demographic data points with the estimation models are lacking significantly. This would allow modeling more personally and more accurately, taking inter-individual variability into consideration, which may benefit performance in a variety of populations.
- V. **Security and Privacy of the End-to-End System:** Much energy has been spent on maximizing the accuracy of the BP estimation algorithm; however, significantly less effort has been focused on the security and privacy of the entire, combined IoT system. This is a serious oversight in a medical device dealing with sensitive Protected Health Information (ePHI). There are lapses in reporting the end-to-end encryption mechanism, secure device authentication mechanism, strong cloud access controls, and ensuring adherence to data protection policies such as HIPAA and GDPR.[8] An afterthought approach to design cannot be used in a clinically viable system.

The apparent "accuracy arms race" seen in academic literature, where studies report incrementally better performance metrics, often masks these more fundamental issues. It can be misleading when a slightly smaller Mean Absolute Error (MAE) is pursued on a benchmark dataset when the methodology is not robustly validated or capable of being applied to the real world. The real problem is not only to obtain high accuracy under controlled conditions, but also to create a system that is reliable, safe, and clinically meaningful to various individuals in their everyday lives. This necessitates moving away from an algorithmic optimization-only approach towards a broader, systems-level approach that emphasizes strong validation, artifact robustness, and regulatory compliance

## 2.4 Summary

In the context of the background investigation, it is clear that the area of PPG-based blood pressure estimation is an active one with a very fast pace of development. The technological development of the dual-sensor PTT approaches to single-sensor, feature-based machine learning and, finally, an end-to-end deep learning are clearly evolving in the more sustainable and viable direction. The connection to IoT platforms also has the potential to bring these algorithmic breakthroughs to scalable, at-a-distance health surveillance. Nevertheless, this promise is checked by serious and continuing challenges. The dependence on calibration, absence of uniform validation

procedures, susceptibility to motion artifacts and lack of connection with the larger physiological picture are among the greatest areas of research deficiency and clinical application. The proposed project aims to fill these gaps in the presentation of a comprehensive system approach that is not only founded on a state-of-the-art AI model, but is also rooted in the principles of rigorous evaluation, regulatory compliance, and secure system design

# Chapter 3

## Research Methodology

This chapter explains in detail the approach used to develop a cuffless blood pressure prediction approach based on IoT-based photoplethysmography (PPG) signal processing and machine learning models. It includes preprocessing of raw data, feature extraction, architecture of several machine learning and deep learning algorithms, and justification for selecting and comparing several modeling methodologies.

### 3.1 Methodology

#### 3.1.1 Overview

The methodology used to develop a non-invasive blood pressure prediction system is proposed and it consists of several parts: IoT device, web interface, backend system and machine learning models. This methodology allows for prediction of blood pressure in real time according to photoplethysmography (PPG) signals, which are processed and analyzed in a sequence of well-defined steps [6][25].

In this paper, the IoT device, developed and programmed in C++, is used as the data acquisition unit, it is the interface between sensors (MAX30102) that sends PPG signals. Different hardware-based methods based on optical sensors have been validated in several studies for cuffless BP measurement [8][28][30]. The device is connected to the web system and sends the data it collects for further processing. The information is then processed through a web interface, which is created using HTML, CSS and JavaScript. Through this interface, users enter the demographic information (e.g., age, gender, height, and weight) and get the predicted blood pressure based on the trained machine learning models, which is related to multi-modal feature fusion strategies in literature [6][24].

The back-end application is written in Node.js technology and provides seamless communication between IoT device and Web interface. It helps the data to pass from the device to the website where the data is stored and processed. In addition, the backend also handles the interface between the inputs from the user and the predictive models, a common model in cloud-edge health monitoring schemes [27][30].

Once the data has been collected, it is passed through exception handling for the purpose of handling the errors that may occur during data collection, transmission, or processing. After this, the data is preprocessed, which means cleaning the data and preparing it for the next stages of the analysis. Statistical features such as skewness, kurtosis, and the number of peaks in the PPG signal are extracted during the feature extraction phase as these statistical features have exhibited their importance in predicting blood pressure [1][9][21]. Frequency-domain features derived from discrete Fourier transform (FFT)-based energy in different bands were also extracted, in line with previous research on the spectral basis of hemodynamic variability [7][16].

The processed data is then split into two portions, training data and test data. The machine learning models are trained using the training data while the test data is used for model evaluation. Similar validation process has been applied to GPM studies for BP

estimation targeting avoidance of overfitting and for generalizability purpose.[2][20] Linear regression, Random forest regressor, ANN, SVR, KNN, Ada Boost Regressor, and Bidirectional Long Short Term Memory (BiLSTM) models are trained in Python on Google Colab. Each of the models is tested using commonly used regression metrics including Mean Absolute Error (MAE), Root Mean Square Error (RMSE), and R2 score, to find the optimal model [3][15][17].

Once the best model is selected, it is implemented via the backend system, where it can be used to make real-time predictions of blood pressure based on new inputs from a user. The final prediction is presented in the web interface, from which users receive the predictive result of their blood pressure readings immediately [12][19]. This solution brings together hardware, software, and machine learning to produce a seamless platform for noninvasive and accurate blood pressure assessment.

This way, not only an efficient workflow is guaranteed from the data collection to the model deployment, but a modern best practice in IoT, web development, and machine learning, offering an effective and user-friendly solution for real-time health monitoring [23][26].

### **3.1.2 Proposed Methodology**

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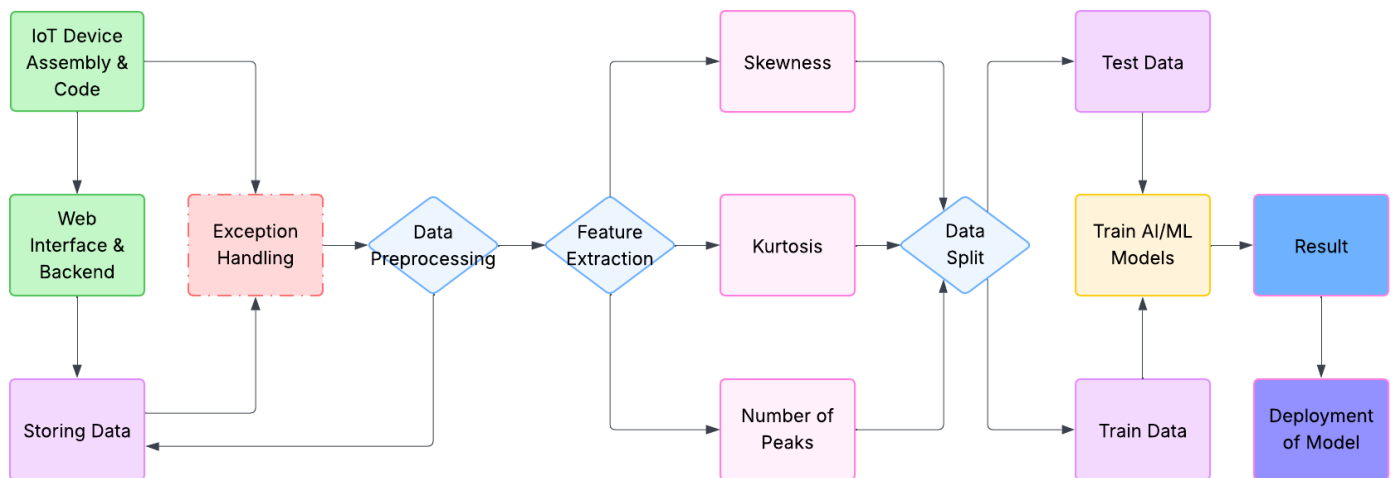


Figure 3.1: Proposed Methodology Diagram

## 3.2 Detailed Methodology and Design

### 3.2.1 Data Preprocessing

Raw PPG was received on the sensor as a high dimensional waveform sample of the infrared (IR) waveform and the red lighting channel. About 409 columns, which characterized temporal variation of the blood volume changes recorded at high finally were produced at every measurement session. Like most physiological signals, raw PPG is subject to motion artifact, ambient light interference, and baseline wandering noise that can conceal information about hemodynamics. Thus, extensive preprocessing was introduced to create a dataset that could be used in machine learning models.[16][25]

Preprocessing pipeline started with cleaning up of the data. Illegal entries, including rows whose error fields are traditional placeholders (e.g. -999 heart rate or SpO<sub>2</sub>). Still incomplete or bad sensor readings were also eliminated. Categorical variables e.g. gender were coded numerically using label encoding to ensure that they could be regressed with the rest of the dataset.

In the next stage, the extraction of features was conducted in an effort to extract meaningful auto programs out of the IR PPG waveform. The hybrid between statistical and spectral description was chosen. Descriptors in the time domain consisted of the average, median, standard deviation, minimum, maximum, traditional basis, skewness and kurtosis of the signal distribution. The means like the quantity of peaks per portion and the average peak amplitude among others were summarized through morphological renunciations with the help of peak showing calculations. Such descriptors are physiologically pertinent since peak counts are affected by the pulse rate, while the asymmetry of the waveforms and their kurtosis correspond to the stiffness of arteries and the resistance of the vessels.[4]

The analysis was done on frequency-domain Fast Fourier Transform (FFT). Based on the spectral profile, the most common frequency was removed, and it is usually associated with cardiac rhythm. Other descriptors were the total spectral energy, low-frequency (0.5-3 Hz) and high-frequency (3-6 Hz) band powers that denote autonomic feedback of cardiovascular activity.[7][21]

First, both IR and red PPG signal features were obtained producing 28 signal descriptors during a session. Demographic factors (age, gender, height, weight, BMI) and vital signs (heart rate, SpO<sub>2</sub>) were also added, which produced a deep dataset. Nevertheless, during experimental work, it was established that red channel characteristics and SpO<sub>2</sub> values add minimal predictive information, tellingly by their response to the position of the sensor and fluctuations in ambient light. As such, they were left out in the final dataset. The filtered dataset therefore included about 20-25 characteristics per observation and systolic and diastolic BP observations that were collected with an Omron cuff-based sphygmomanometer regarded as a gold standard in the noninvasive clinical monitoring.[26][27]



### 3.2.2 Models for Blood Pressure Prediction.

#### Linear Regression

Linear regression was used as a benchmark model, because it is readily interpretable and mathematically simple.[32] The approach approximates blood pressure as linear relation of input features:

$$\hat{y} = \beta_0 + \sum_{i=1}^n \beta_i x_i \quad (1)$$

In which  $\hat{y}$  the parameter that predicts BP,  $x_i$  are features based on PPG signals and demographics and  $\beta_i$  are constants that have been learned by minimizing the squared error. Although linear regression will hardly be able to address the nonlinearities of cardiovascular dynamics, it allows determining a new compelling point against which to compare the incremental improvements made by more advanced models.

#### Random Forest Regression

Random Forests (RFs) is a type of ensemble approach, which builds several decision trees throughout training and gives an average of all decision trees.[31] All the trees divide the input space into smaller parts through recursive subdivisions based on the features that achieve highest degree of variance reduction.

$$\hat{y} = \frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=1}^T \hat{y}_{tree_t} \quad (2)$$

Thresholds on IR spectral energy or BMI can then be used to separate the feature space into subpopulations having different BP, e.g. as the training data used may have biases toward social media usage. RF averages predicted values across the large number of trees, which reduces the risk of overfitting individual relationships and is tolerant to noisy physiological predictors. Previous research has demonstrated that RFs can better predict PPG-based BP estimation since they can support nonlinear dependencies and heterogeneous contributions of a feature.[17]

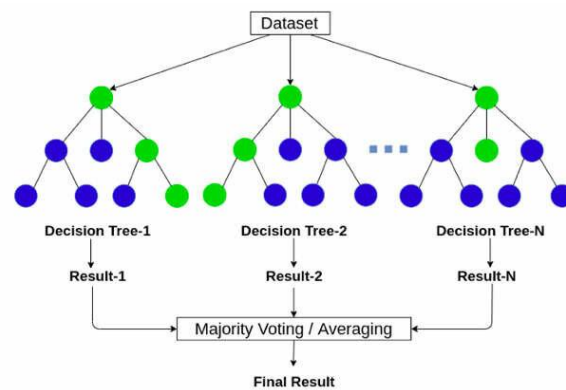


Figure 3.2: Illustration of Random Forest Architecture.

## Gradient Boosted Trees (XGBoost)

Gradient Boosting and, in particular, the XGBoost algorithm enhance the quality of ensemble algorithms by creating trees in sequence such that each tree tries to regularize the mistakes that the ensemble has made so far [33]. According to the model the BP values can be predicted as:

$$\hat{y} = \sum_{m=1}^M f_m(x), \quad f_m \in \mathcal{F} \quad (3)$$

where  $f_m$  are regression trees. Regularization conditions do not favor very complex models, so the models can be generalized to different patients. Due to its capability to acknowledge both decipherability and high predictive capacity at the same time, as well as its adaptation to considerable contemporary datasets, including those provided by IoT sensor,[23] XGBoost has become a popular tool in the biomedical signal modelling domain.

## Support Vector Regression

Support Vector Regression (SVR) is an application of support vector machines as used in regression.[34] The SVR tries to approximate a fitting of a function that predicts blood pressure and lets be deviate by tolerance epsilon. The fitness is the minimization of the weight vector norm  $\|w\|^2$  under:

$$|y_i - (w \cdot \phi(x_i) + b)| \leq \epsilon \quad (4)$$

where  $\phi(x)$  projects features in a high dimension space through a kernel function. The radial basis function (RBF) kernel is especially well adapted for PPG signals, to the extent that it approximates nonlinear relationships across features. Past studies have already shown that SVR is indeed the appropriate approach in estimating the continuous BP that utilizes the features of PPG.[29]

## K-Nearest Neighbors Regression

The KNN regression estimates the BP by averaging the values of the k nearest training examples in video space. Similarity was measured based on Euclidean distance between IR derived features and demographics. When X, O is known, Y is unknown:  $XO = YO$ .

**Euclidean Distance** equation:

$$d(x, y) = \sqrt{(\sum_{i=1}^n (x_i - y_i)^2)} \quad (5)$$

For predicting values like blood pressure, KNN performs regression using the following equation:

$$\hat{y} = \frac{1}{K} \sum_{i=1}^K y_i \quad (6)$$

KNN is more computationally expensive at inference time, but can utilize local structure within the data and can be used when the sample size is more than relatively small, as in this example. It has been used in small datasets to provide physiological signal regression results in areas where local neighborhoods capture individual variability.[13]

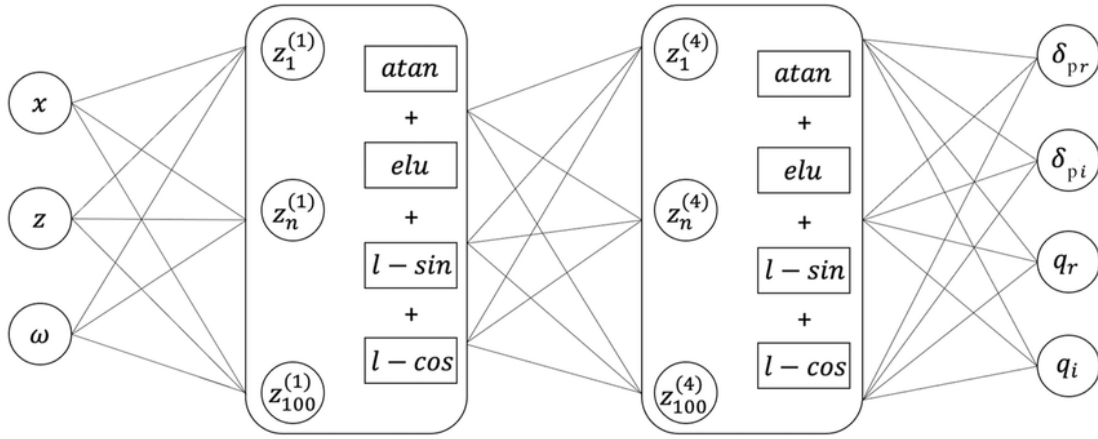


Figure 3.3: Illustration of KNN Architecture.

### Artificial Neural Networks

Artificial Neural Networks (ANNs) were used as multilayer perceptrons (MLPs) that had 64-128 neurons in two to three hidden layers and one output layer generating systolic and diastolic forecasts. The nonlinear transformations are used on each of the layers:

$$a^l = f(W^l a^{l-1} + b^l) \quad (7)$$

and in the case of the ReLU activation function,  $f(\cdot)$  is generally. ANNs are also optimal to elicit nonlinear relationships between PPG morphology and BP, having been confirmed by the previous experiments predicting patient-specific BP using PPG[3]. In other architecture dropout layers were used to help discourage overfitting.

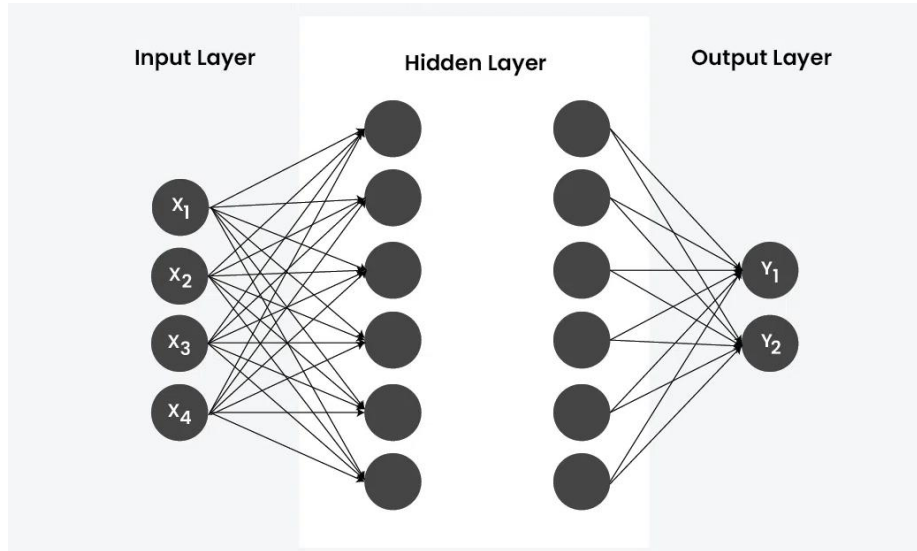


Figure 3.3: Illustration of ANN with dense layers Architecture.

### Bidirectional Long Short-Term Memory Networks

As the PPG signals are inherently temporal signals, recurrent neural architectures were another option to consider as well. The Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) nets learn long-term relationships across time series within a time sequence by storing memory cells controlled by input, forget, and output gates.[35] The BiLSTM version works on the sequence in two directions forward and backward, allowing a model to capture the context of the entire waveform. To compute the hidden state update,  $x_t$  will be used as input

sequence, where:

$$C_t = f_t \odot C_{t-1} + i_t \odot \underline{C}_t, h_t = o_t \odot \tanh(C_t) \quad (8)$$

where  $i_t$ ,  $f_t$ ,  $o_t$ , are input, forget and output gates, respectively. BiLSTMs have been shown to provide state estimates of cuffless BP using signal transitions that contain the dynamics of the vascular response in PPG signals.[15][18]

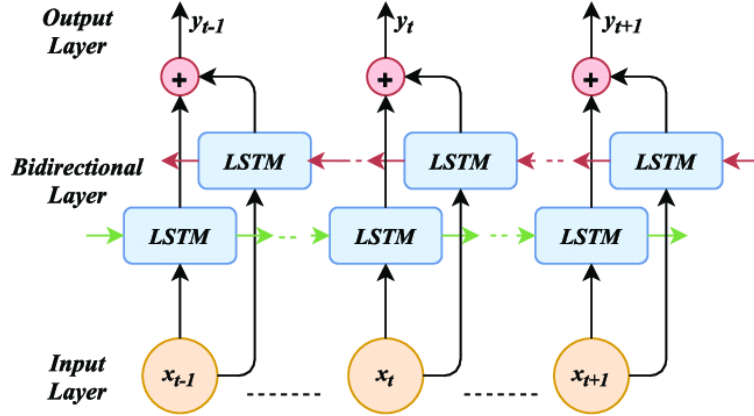


Figure 3.2: Illustration of Random Forest Architecture.

### AdaBoost Regression

AdaBoost (Adaptive Boosting) is an ensemble learning algorithm that builds a strong learning model with the combination of multiple weak models (usually decision trees). Its use in regression would mean successively adding weak learners to the data and altering their weights to concentrate at misclassified data.

This is the final prediction of regression: a weighted average of all weak-learners gets predictions:

$$\hat{y} = \sum_{t=1}^T \alpha_t \cdot \hat{y}_t \quad (9)$$

Where  $\hat{y}_t$  is the prediction of the t-th weak learner, and  $T$  is the number of iterations.

AdaBoost Regression is often applied to decision tree splits (decision stump) because those are weak learners, but any simple regression model can also be used as the weak learner. The decision tree models in AdaBoost are shallow (usually of a depth no more than 1), that is, the algorithm produces many weak decision models that can be cumulatively refined.

### 3.2.3 Justification for Model Diversity

The complexity of the underlying physiological task is reflected in the fact that a large variety of models are tested. Nonlinear responses pertaining to vascular resistance, arterial compliance, and cardiac output act upon blood pressure, all of which are indirectly represented on the PPG waveform.[26] There is no single model family that has received universal approval as being best in this regard. Ensemble tree strains provide interpretability and predictability, kernel-based approaches provide nonlinear mapping flexibility, skeletal neural structures more effectively learn hidden temporal and structural structures. An overlay of these paradigms provides the methodological rigor of assuring highest probability of an architecture that can be generalized through subjects.

### 3.3 Project Plan

### 3.4 Task Allocation

This table depicts the timeline of the principal activities in each period of the project, from week 1 to week 37.

Table 3.1: Task Allocation Timeline

| Tasks                                             | Weeks |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------|---|---|---|---|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
|                                                   | 1     | 3 | 5 | 7 | 9 | 11 | 13 | 15 | 17 | 19 | 21 | 23 | 25 | 27 | 29 | 31 | 33 | 35 | 37 |
| Literature Review & Problem Definition            |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| IoT Device Assembly                               |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| IoT Device Code                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| Frontend Develop                                  |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| Backend Develop                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| Ensure Data Flow                                  |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| Data Collection                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| Data Preprocessing                                |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| AI Model Development                              |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| AI Model Deployment                               |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| Comparison Optimization, and Final Report Writing |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|                                                   |       |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |

The given table of task allocation timeline is the elaborated schedule of a project completion with 37 weeks and most important activities on its vertical axis. The initial steps of the project are the Literature Review and Problem Definition (weeks 1-5) and after that is IoT Device Assembly (weeks 5-13) that is composed of hardware assembly, as well as, coding. Week 11: Over the next weeks, the frontend is developed, it runs in parallel with APIs and backend, which will start in the paper week 13 and will be used to create APIs and to work through data flow (weeks 17-21). The period during which data collection process will occur is protracted and will cover the duration of weeks 17-29 where enough time will be available to collect and process data required by the machine learning models. The development of AI models begins in week 21 and extends to week 29 and then model deployment follows between week 29-33. In the last, the period between weeks 33-

37 requires comparison, optimization, and scoring the final report, a process that manages results in refining and proper documentation. Such an organization enables the development to be mapped in parallel without excluding hardware, software, and machine learning undertakings hence flexibility in making adjustments in the whole project.

### 3.5 Summary

this research paper discusses the approach followed towards the creation of a non-invasive blood pressure (BP) monitoring system on the basis of an IoT-driven platform and machine learning models. The chapter starts with the description of the data collection procedure, in which physiological data had been collected with the use of a maximal of three data sensors, namely a MAX30102 PPG sensor with an ESP32 microcontroller. This sensor captured PPG signals and this was sent/transmitted through an IoT protocol to be processed and analyzed. This is followed by the discussion of the data preprocessing whereby the raw PPG data was preprocessed and irrelevant noise eliminated to make features be extracted more accurately. The PPG signals yielded key features, such as heart rate and SpO<sub>2</sub>, to be enabled to be used in model training. Another aspect that the methodology identifies is machine learning models that had been used in prediction of blood pressure such as Random Forest, AdaBoost, XGBoost, and BiLSTM. The data was preprocessed, and the models were trained and hyperparameters were tuned to order to maximize their performance. Model accuracy was assessed using various performance indexes as Mean Absolute Error (MAE), Root Same Square Error (RMSE), R-squared, and per cent errors (Mean Absolute Percentage error or (MAPE)). Moreover, the chapter describes how ensemble techniques may be used to enhance the accuracy of predictions, through incorporating the strengths of several models. All the final models were considered to see their ability of generalization but mainly to improve their performance in real world cases, especially in wearable and portable litigating, BP. Finally, this chapter defines a holistic approach to combining IoT-collected data with machine learning-trained models with their performance assessment to develop a non-invasive and precise system of BP monitoring.

# Chapter 4

## Implementation and Results

This chapter presents the implementation of the IoT–AI blood pressure prediction system and provides a detailed analysis of the results. It begins with an overview of the environment setup for both IoT hardware and software, followed by a comparative analysis of machine learning and deep learning models.

### 4.1 Environment Setup

#### 4.1.1 IoT Device Environment

The IoT board was created based on the ESP32 NodeMCU V1.3 development board, built in with a photoplethysmography (PPG) sensor, the MAX30102. Testing In early design experiments the device could be powered directly, with any power bank, via a USB-B connection, which served as a stable and convenient power source and did not need explicit circuitry. This arrangement minimized the work required to debug and provided continuous operation when testing data collection. After stability was achieved, the connections to power supply were changed to the rechargeable 18650 lithium-ion battery having its own holder and Type-C fast-charging module, enabling the device to be pushed into the acrylic enclosure to make it portable. The real-time monitoring and control of the device was carried out using 16x2 LCD display module with I2C adapter and push-button interface. Using WiFiManager library, the ESP32 was able to reach local Wi-Fi networks in real-time, allowing it to transmit data without hardcoding any credentials. Such an environment of flexible hardware provided a level of adaptability even within various testing conditions.

#### 4.1.2 Web and Backend Environment

The web-based and backend infrastructure was deployed in a Node.js server with a connection to a MongoDB Atlas cluster. The backend supported a variety of API endpoints to receive incoming sensor data and store it in the ‘raw\_data’ collection, then enrich with demographic information (age, gender, height, weight, BMI) and blood pressure records to add it to the ‘total\_data’ collection. The backend was launched to Vercel which uses built-in encryption (TLS/HTTPS) to communicate securely. Vercel was also used to deploy the frontend web interface as another application to enable users to send inputs to the system. This normalization of the server and the client allowed the application to scale and maintain. In the deployment, the standards of RESTful API have been used to ensure interoperability between the components. MongoDB data segregation enabled effective dataset preparation to train a model, as well as live data integration with the MongoDB prediction API. It was a web environment with a strong backbone to facilitate communication between IoT and cloud and the web.

### 4.1.3 Model Development Environment

Google Colab Pro was the main training and evaluation environment selected, with the benefit of long runtime visibility and increased resource limit, including the use of a virtual or physical GPU based on the application. Popular Python libraries like scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Keras, and XGBoost were used to implement and run several regression and deep learning models, which later were tested in the environment. The preprocessing of data and visualization were conducted with pandas, NumPy, seaborn, and matplotlib. Besides cloud-based resources, Dell Inspiron 15 5510 laptop using Intel Core i7-11390H processor (8-core), 16 GB RAM, and Windows 11 home 64-bit was used to develop it primarily as a local resource. This laptop assisted in code writing in the back-end as well as integrating the websites along with verifying the initial data sets. The message-passing workflow between the compute-intensive parts, which was performed on the dual-environment workflow, Colab, and the local machine, the local machine provided efficiency in both experimentation and deployment. In combination with the hardware of the IoT and with a web system hosted by Vercel, this development setup at the model made the basis of the computations of the project

### 4.1.4 Environment Workflow

In this section the whole workflow of the system is shown and discussed in detail.

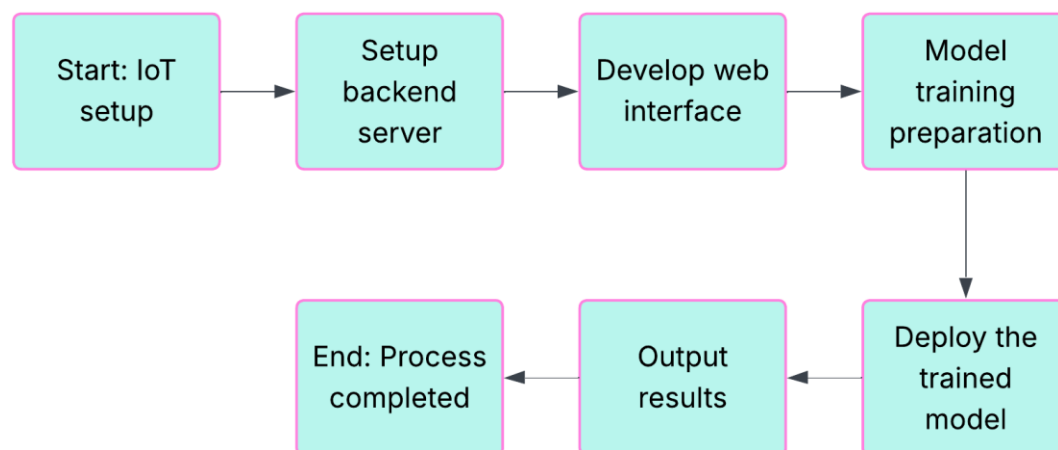


Figure 4.1: Workflow of IoT-AI Blood Pressure Prediction System.

The figure shows a flow chart of the steps undertaken sequentially during the implementation of IoT-AI based blood pressure prediction system. This will start with the solution of IoT where the ESP32 and MAX30102 sensor will be programmed to collect data. The second step after testing the hardware operational and finding that it functions performs the task of the backend server, which provides two-way communication between the IoT device, database, and web application. This is then balanced by development of the web interface, here users can add demographic information and receive system predictions.

Once the system infrastructure is in place, the process proceeds to model training preparation as defined by taking raw physiological data, processing it (i.e. preprocessing), preparing it to be used in machine learning activities. The trained model is subsequently



deployed along the backend API, and it can be inferred in real time. The system then moves to the output results phase where the user can read the systolic and diastolic blood pressure as per their prediction through the web interface on the display. Lastly, the workflow ends with the end of a process and completes the circle between the acquisition of the IoT data, backend processing, AI prediction and end-user feedback.

## 4.2 Comparative Analysis

This part of the report summarizes and compares performance of diverse machine learning models that are used to predict systolic and diastolic blood pressure (BP). The training and testing data includes 536 samples: 18 X variables, and 2 target variables (systolic and diastolic BP). The data has been separated into a 80 percentage training set or 20 percent testing set. The analyzed models are Linear Regression, Random Forest, XGBoost, Artificial Neural Network (ANN), BiLSTM, AdaBoost Regression, K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN), and Support Vector Machine (SVM) Regression. Google Colab with various Python libraries specifically for ML and DL models building was used to train the models and analyze the results on important criteria such as Mean Absolute Error (MAE), Root Mean Square Error (RMSE), R2 and Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE). Each model is analyzed in the following subsections in connection to several performance visualizations such as scatter plots, residual plots, and accuracy curves (Error CDF).

### 4.2.1 Linear Regression

Some of the least complex models that are utilized in regression tasks include Linear Regression. It supposes that the features (similar to independent variable) and the target (similar to dependent variable) vary in a linear manner. Systolic BP and diastolic BP are the target variables in this case.

**True vs. Predicted (Linear Regression):**

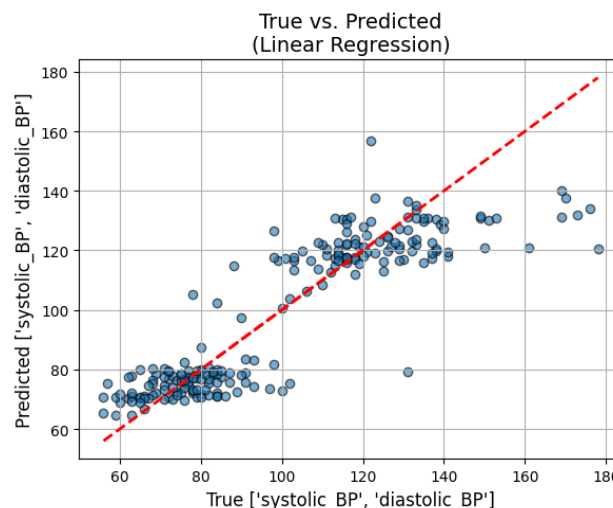


Figure 4.2: True vs Predicted(Linear Regression)

True vs. Predicted scatter plot Linear regression demonstrates a good fit to most of the paradigms particularly the ones at the lower range of systolic and diastolic BP. As the values rise however, the forecasts begin to lose contact with the actual values, meaning that the model is not able to handle such high BP values. The red dotted line is the perfect case in which the predicted values and the true values occur to the same level.

### Residuals Plot (Linear Regression):

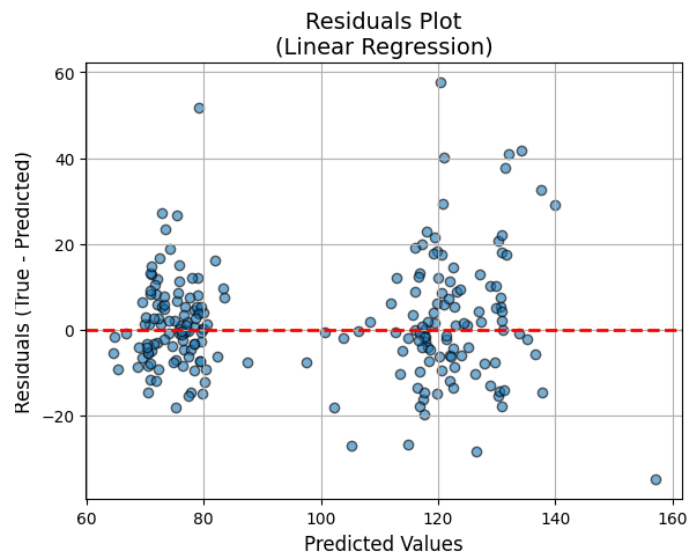


Figure 4.3: Residuals Plot of Linear Regression

The Linear Regression plot of the Residual will indicate that the residual values (the difference between the actual and predicted values) are distributed fairly around zero with no apparent patterns. This is an indication that there is no massive bias and/or variance on this model. There is, however, a bit of clustering of residuals at some points and this could accurately indicate overfitting of the data within particular ranges.

### Accuracy Curve (Error CDF):

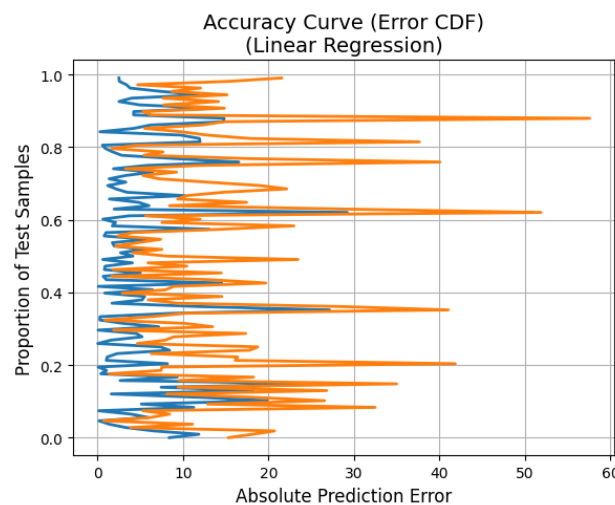


Figure 4.4: Accuracy Curve of Linear Regression

Accuracy Curve Linear Regression demonstrates that the error of prediction made by the model distributed widely, and there is a significant dispersion between the error of prediction. The error percentage of a considerable fraction of the test samples is greater than the error of more sophisticated models such as Random Forest and XGBoost. This can be seen in the MAE and RMSE values in the last model comparison table which are 9.39 and 13.25 respectively.

### Performance Analysis:

Linear Regression works fairly well with lower systolic and diastolic BP but not as BP

risers. The large dispersion along the Accuracy Curve and greater dispersion in the higher range of the Accuracy Curve indicate that the model performs poorly in extreme BP scales. The MAE and RMSE are 9.40 and 13.26 respectively, which means that the model makes a moderate prediction error, especially when high values of BP are used. Linear Regression is also subject to underfitting in cases where the correlation between features and target values are not linear. The weakness of the model to deal with outliers or data pattern causes more errors in prediction to occur as BP grows. As a result more sophisticated models, including Random Forest or XGBoost are able to better represent these complexities.

### Results:

- MAE: 9.39
- MSE: 175.70
- RMSE: 13.25
- $R^2$ : 0.19
- MAPE: 9.17%

### 4.2.2 Random Forest

Random Forest is an ensemble-based learning technique that develops multiple decision trees and integrates them with each other to enhance accuracy and minimize overfitting. Random Forest is a better model of non-linear relationships than Linear Regression and better at avoiding overfitting than separate decision trees. For this study, the Random forest model was tuned to provide a better result.

### True vs. Predicted (Random Forest):

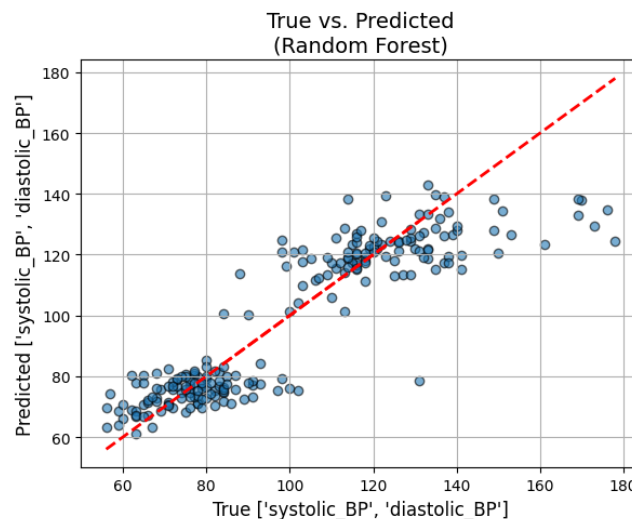


Figure 4.5: Ture vs Predicted (Random Forest)

Merely a glance at the True vs. Predicted plot of the Random Forest reveals a far more accurate fit than that of the Linear Regression with most predictions closely matching the true values. The model treats the larger values of BP even better than the Linear Regression model because the points are closer to the red dashed line, hence a good correlation between the expected or actual systolic/diastolic BP values obtained.

### Residuals plot (Random Forest):

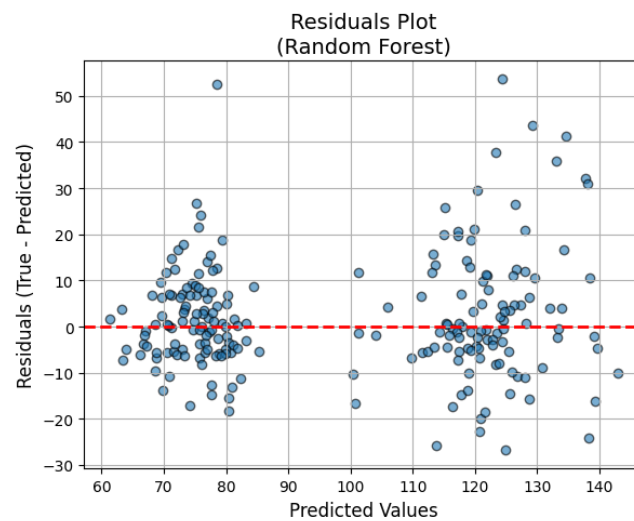


Figure 4.5: Residual Plot of Random Forest

The random Forest residual plot is centered around zero and there is no any major trends and patterns that suggest the residual value model is not being plagued by huge levels of bias and variance. This indicates that this model has a high rate of generalization to the test set.

### Accuracy Curve (Error CDF):

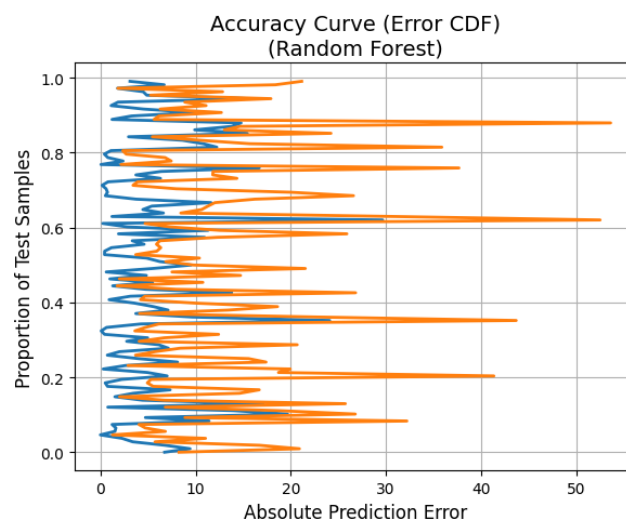


Figure 4.5: Accuracy Curve of Random Forest

Accuracy Curve of Random Forest indicates that it never produces errors in its prediction as much as Linear regression does. The distribution of errors is smaller, meaning that the random forest gives a greater percentage of correct predictions. The MAE = 9.08 and RMSE = 12.87 is less than the Linear Regression, which means it performs better.

### Performance Analysis:

Random Forest also behaves well in the whole range of BP values. The model captures more non-linear trends on the data and its predictions are more accurate overall compared to Linear Regression. This is made possible by its capacity to address not only the complex features and interactions. Although the model was tuned for better performance, it did not have the desired effect.

### Results:

- MAE: 9.08
- MSE: 165.73
- RMSE: 12.87
- $R^2$ : 0.24
- MAPE: 8.83%

### 4.2.3 XGBoost

XGBoost is a very fast, efficient implementation of gradient boosting, an algorithm that is said to be fast and accurate. It constructs a combination of decision tree and each tree attempts to resolve the mistakes that the last one made.

### True vs. Predicted (XGBoost):

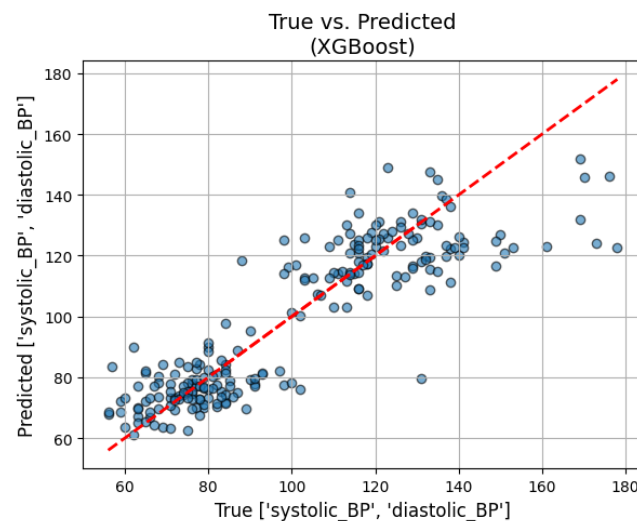


Figure 4.5: True vs Predicted (XGBoost)

Both the True vs. Predicted plot and the XGBoost display excellent performance with the prediction coming very close to the true values, particularly the higher readings of the BP. The model was also more stable and had fewer deviations when compared to the Random Forest, especially near extreme values of systolic and diastolic BP.

### Residuals Plot (XGBoost):

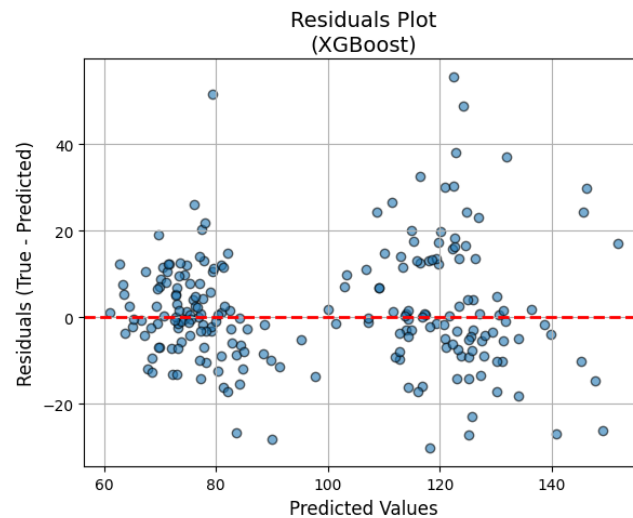


Figure 4.5: Residual Plot of XGBoost

XGBoost plot on the residuals indicates the distribution of the residuals follows normal distribution, and only some few extreme outliers. The residual distribution indicates that the model is highly suitable to complete this task because of its low bias as well as variance.

### Accuracy Curve (Error CDF):

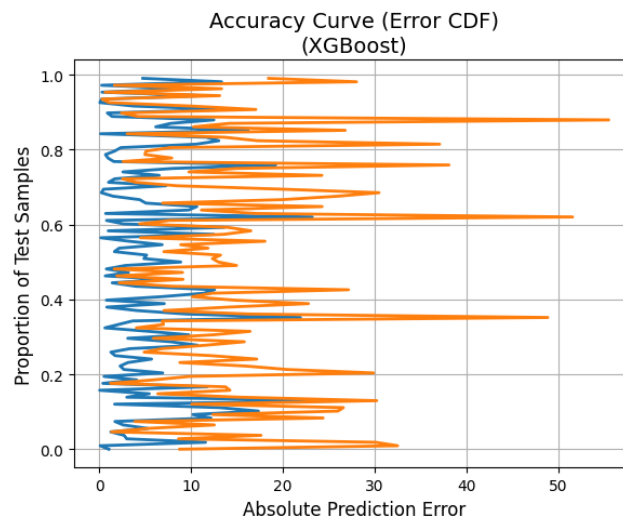


Figure 4.5: Accuracy Curve of XGBoost

Accuracy Curve of the XGBoost reveals that the model predicts fairly accurately all the time, and there are a more significant number of test samples with low absolute prediction errors. Compared to Random Forest, the MAE value of 9.80 and RMSE of 13.61 are just marginally inferior, though the overall performance of the model is still higher than the Linear Regression model.

### Performance Analysis:

XGBoost ranks among the successful models because it has the lowest MAE (9.79) and lowest RMSE (13.61). The model is good at describing both complex and simple patterns in the data. XGBoost manages high BP values better than other models and can handle

non-linear relationships. In the Accuracy Curve, the distribution of errors has the highest concentration around the smaller values, which means that XGBoost always makes correct predictions. Its robust generalising features enable it an excellent model to predict systolic and diastolic BP in real life situations, better than other models such as Linear Regression, random forest, and ANN in accuracy and consistency.

#### Results:

- MAE: 9.80
- MSE: 185.26
- RMSE: 13.61
- $R^2$ : 0.14
- MAPE: 9.61%

#### 4.2.4 Artificial Neural Network (ANN)

ANN are known to learn the complex and non-linear relationships. It is a model that considers several layers of neurons to operate the relationship between input features and produce predictions.

#### True vs. Predicted (ANN):

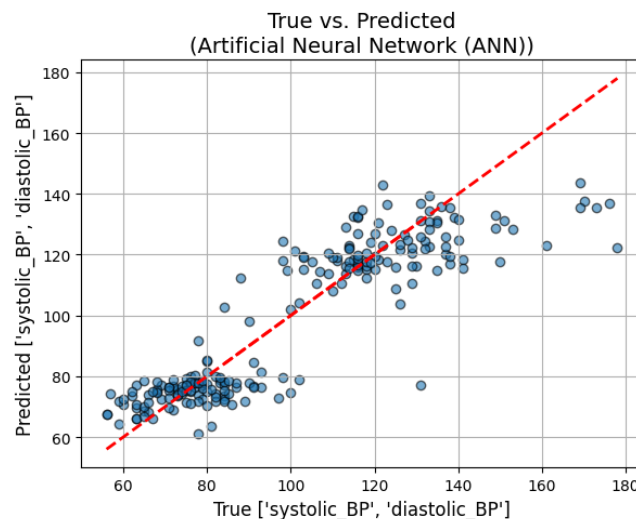


Figure 4.5: Ture vs Predicted (ANN)

The True vs. Predicted plot of Artificial Neural Network (ANN) indicates a fair fit of most of the test cases with the predictions nearly approximating the truths. But significant deviations are observed in the model with higher BP values especially in systolic BP values. Although ANN can be used to learn non-linear equations, it appears to have problems with extreme values of BP. The spreads of the ideal red dashed line grow higher as BP values go higher and the model does not easily predict higher BP reading. This implies that additional tuning or some form of regularization could be required of ANN to handle outliers or more convoluted data patterns at the ends.

### Residuals Plot (ANN):

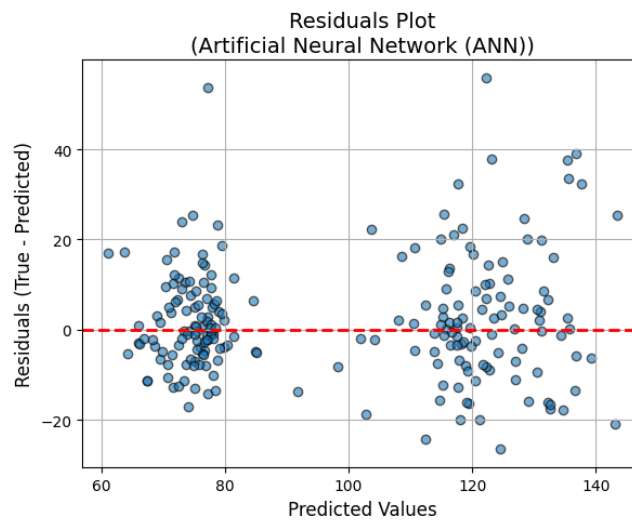


Figure 4.5: Residual Plot of ANN

The Residuals Plot of ANN exhibits larger dispersion than the ensemble model that includes both Random Forest and XGBoost, which suggests the errors of prediction of the model are over a broader range. Although still centred at zero, the residuals show an augmentation of the spread towards the higher BP values, which indicates overfitting of the model to the training history, at the higher ranges in particular. This dispersion is an indication that the model may be susceptible to noise or outliers that may lead to larger deviations in specific predictions. The residuals scheme shows that ANN needs to be enhanced concerning the generalisation; particularly, to extreme ABNP forecasts.

### Accuracy Curve (Error CDF):

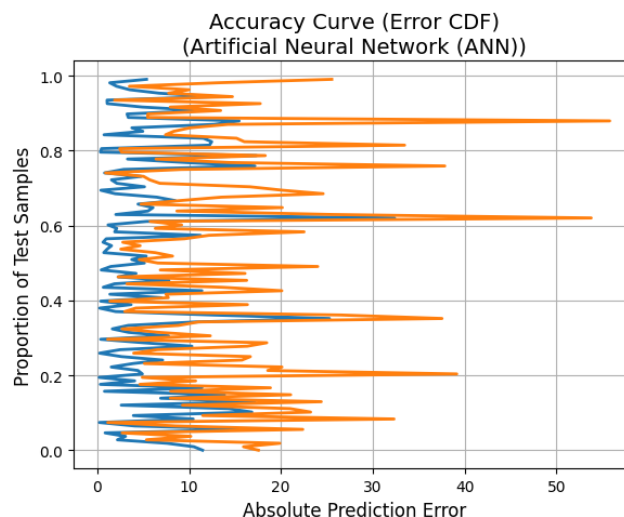


Figure 4.5: Accuracy Curve of ANN

As indicated by the Accuracy Curve of ANN, the spread in the errors of predictions is relatively greater than that offered by random forest and even XGBoost, indicating that ANN is not as stable in its performance as the other two models. Though the model works suitably with the majority of our test samples, the errors are more fluctuating especially when higher BP values are concerned due to its MAE of 9.44 and RMSE of 12.99. It is implied by the curve that ANN works well over much of the dataset, but might not work



well with extreme values. The error distribution describes moderate generalization ability over the data.

### Performance Analysis:

In test samples perform well with the Artificial Neural Network (ANN). However it is a problem with extreme readings as can be seen in the larger dispersion in the residuals and larger error distribution in the Accuracy Curve. The MAE and RMSE of the model are 9.44 and 12.99, respectively, which is worse than Linear Regression but not as good as Random Forest or XGBoost. The overfitted nature of the model, particularly when the range of BP is extreme, limits the performance. As effective as ANN is as a model of learning non-linear relationship, the model could require additional tuning to adapt to more varied datasets.

### Results:

- MAE: 9.44
- MSE: 168.82
- RMSE: 12.61
- $R^2$ : 0.21
- MAPE: 9.19%

#### 4.2.5 Bidirectional Long Short-Term Memory (BiLSTM)

BiLSTM is a recurrent neural network (RNN) that can model long-term externalities in a sequence of data. It however does not perform as well in activities where the temporal relationship is not a major agenda.

#### True vs. Predicted (BiLSTM):

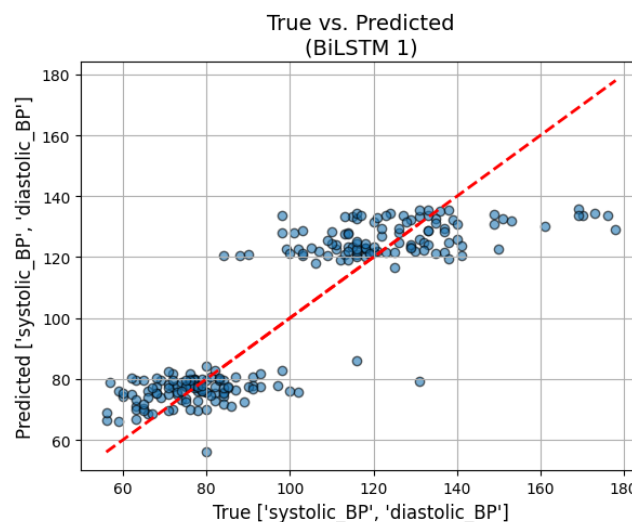


Figure 4.5: Ture vs Predicted (BiLSTM)

True vs. Predicted plot of BiLSTM indicates that the model works satisfactorily with lower and mid-range values of the BP. But at elevated BP readings, the values begin predicting a big difference between the actual values. The temporal dependencies in BiLSTM would be not suitable in this non-sequential data. The test-statistical properties of the deviations in the plot are not a clear evidence that the architecture of BiLSTM is less effective to obtain the complexities of prediction behaviour of BP when sequential dependencies are not as important. The model is not effective at predicting higher values of BP giving very

big gaps between the predicted and actual values.

### Residuals Plot (BiLSTM):

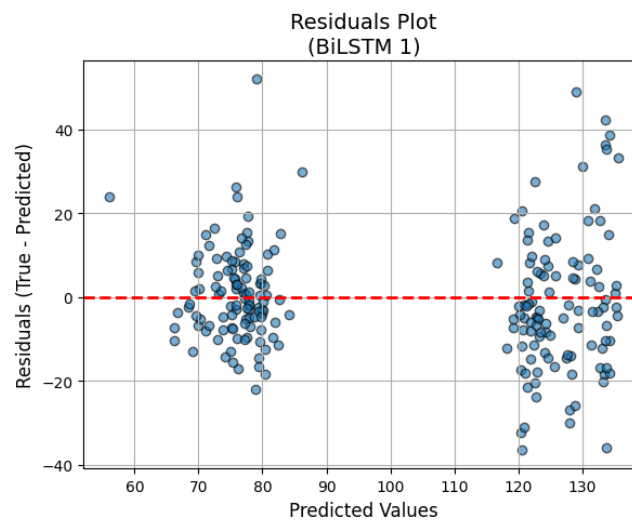


Figure 4.5: Residual Plot of BiLSTM

The Binomial bound logistic model, as depicted on the Residual Plot, has a fairly broad range of values, suggesting that the Binomial model has a larger margin regarding the precision of its predictions than that of the other models as the BP increases. No significant concentration of residuals on either sides, the lower BP values are slightly clustered, however, as BP increases, all the residuals spread out indicating that the model is struggling to explain extreme values in the body property. This probably owes to the nature of the model (architecture) that operates more with sequential statistics as compared to a cross-sectional mechanism such as BP prediction. The diffusion of residues suggests that the BiLSTM has not acquired the inference patterns effectively with an increasing value of BP.

### Accuracy Curve (Error CDF):

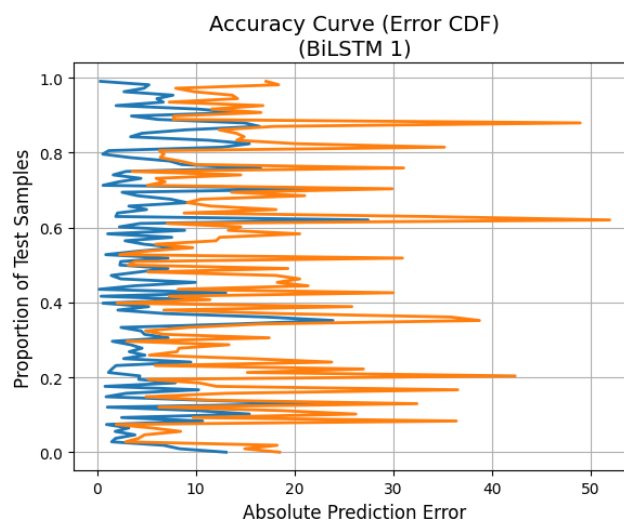


Figure 4.5: Accuracy Curve of BiLSTM

The Accuracy Curve of BiLSTM depicts a consistently bigger range of error values than other models such as Random Forest and XGBoost due to inconsistency of the model. The model can. According to the Accuracy Curve, we cannot say that BiLSTM is the most

suitable option in this regression problem because it is more heterogynous in the error value, especially with more BP readings.

### Performance Analysis:

BiLSTM has a problem predicting high values of BP, with its MAE of 10.21 and RMSE value of 14.09. Although BiLSTM can be applied to sequential data tasks, non-sequential jobs such as BP prediction lead to poor performance. The fact that the error distribution in the Accuracy Curve continues to proliferate and that BiLSTM lacks the ability to capture the complexity of BP data in this situation is indicative of BiLSTM not being the most appropriate model to be used. In this regression task, BiLSTM performs worse than the ensemble models such as the Random Forest and the XGBoost despite promising improvements in some types of data.

### Results:

- MAE: 10.21
- MSE: 198.62
- RMSE: 14.09
- $R^2$ : 0.10
- MAPE: 10.03%

#### 4.2.6 AdaBoost Regression-

AdaBoost is an ensemble technique which aims at minimizing both bias and variance by integrating with a number of weak learners. It can be used to improve the performance of simpler models.

#### True vs. Predicted (AdaBoost):

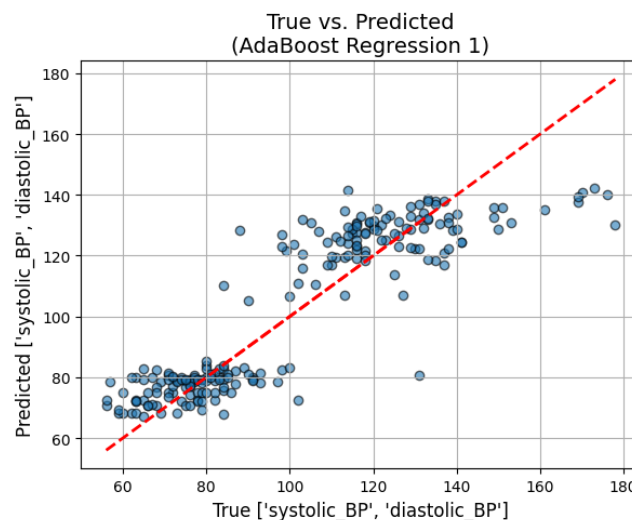


Figure 4.5: Ture vs Predicted (AdaBoost Regression)

AdaBoost True vs. Predicted plot indicates a very good fit to majority of the test samples and the predicted values are very close to the true values. The model tracks fairly well through the entire spectrum of BP values with certain variations on the high end. Ensemble learning algorithm AdaBoost is an algorithm that combines weak models so that its accuracy improves over single models such as Linear Regression. Like all other models, though, there is a minor deviation in those approaching zero or extreme BP values, and this possibly implies that more tuning of the model is required to address

these situations.

### Residuals Plot (AdaBoost):

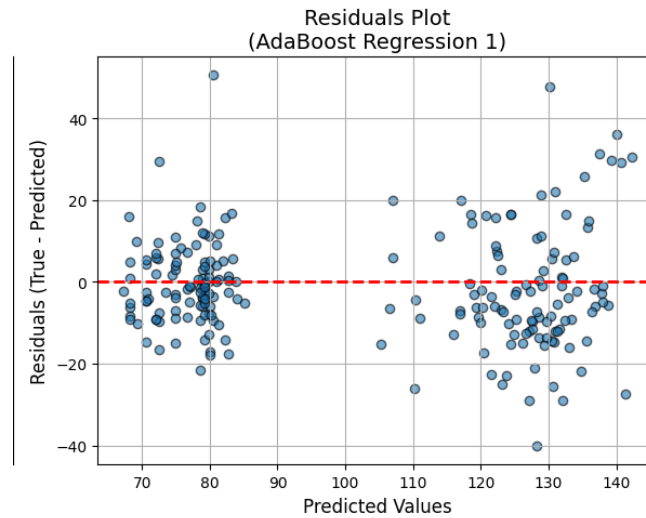


Figure 4.5: Residual Plot of AdaBoost Regression

The AdaBoost Residuals Plot depicts a comparatively tight distribution of the residuals around zero, which indicates the model is not biased. Detecting only a few larger patterns of residues at higher BP values, it looks like AdaBoost makes quick work of most data points, but struggles in extreme instances. On the whole, the distribution of the residuals is satisfactory, indicating the good generalization of AdaBoost over the test data. The lack of any notable trend in the residuals is a sign that AdaBoost is not overfitting or underfitting, and makes AdaBoost a strong predictor of BP.

### Accuracy Curve (Error CDF):

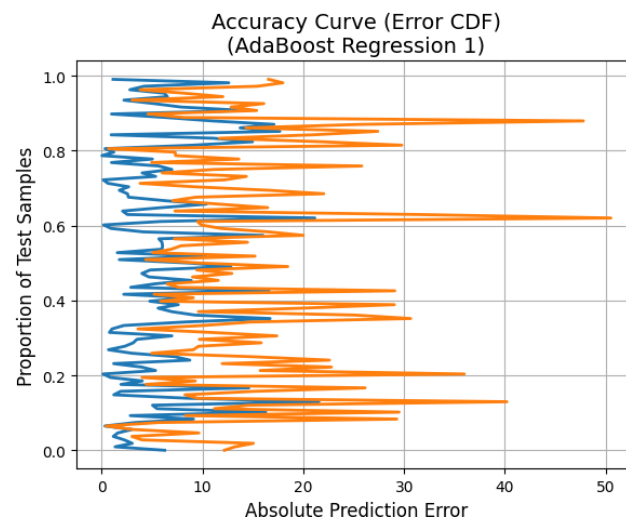


Figure 4.5: Accuracy Curve of AdaBoost

Accuracy Curve of AdaBoost suggests that most test samples are well taken by the model as it has most errors in the low end. MAE of 9.84 and MSE of 13.03 shows that AdaBoost makes constant predictions but it does demonstrate a small rise in error at high values BP. Nonetheless, AdaBoost has a smaller error distribution; therefore, the Accuracy Curve indicates that, it is more dependable to use AdaBoost to predict systolic and diastolic BP compared to Linear Regression.

## Performance Analysis:

AdaBoost Regression gives good results in predicting systolic and diastolic BP with an MAE and RMSE of 9.84 and 13.04 respectively. The Residuals Plot indicates that there is very little bias observed in the model over the test set. Though AdaBoost cannot easily work with larger BP values such as reflected by the slight spread of residuals and increase in errors under the Accuracy Curve, nonetheless it is performing better than other less complex models such as Linear Regression. AdaBoost has a good balanced trade-off between variance and bias hence could be used in predicting tasks that involve BP.

## Results:

- MAE: 9.84
- MSE: 170.29
- RMSE: 13.04
- $R^2$ : 0.23
- MAPE: 9.87

### 4.2.7 K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) Regression.

KNN is a cheap, non-parametric technique which uses some distance between data points to make predictions.

## True vs. Predicted (KNN):

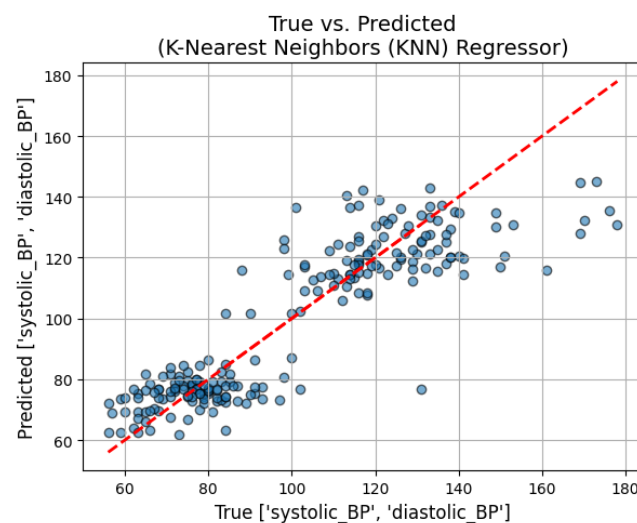


Figure 4.5: Ture vs Predicted (KNN)

True vs. Predicted plot of K-Nearest Neighbours (KNN) indicates that, predictions are scattered, mostly at the higher BP levels. This creates an implication that KNN does not house data with complex relationships. KNN is a non-parametric and simple algorithm that predicts using the average of nearest neighbours. But there it appears to be less useful when one has more significant BP values because the model has deviated the real values. The predicted values do not follow the red dashed line that closely, which means that the level of the error is higher than more advanced models, including Random Forest and XGBoost.

### Residuals Plot (KNN):

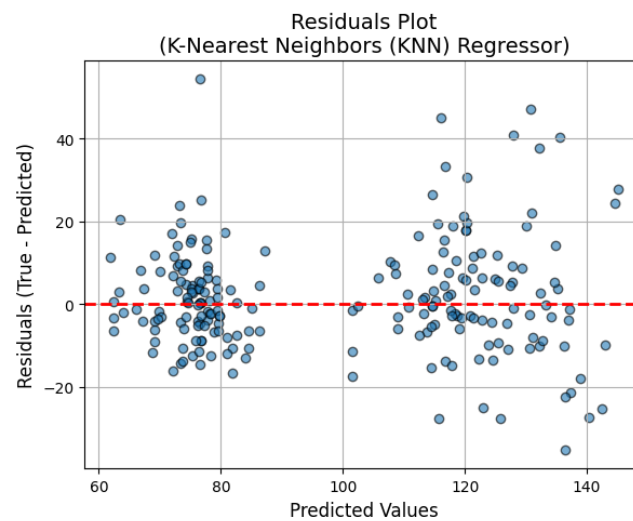


Figure 4.5: Residual Plot of KNN

According to the Residuals Plot of KNN, the distribution is wider than other models which means that KNN has more errors in its prediction. The bigger residuals imply that KNN does not attempt to model the patterns underlying data as well as Random Forest or XGBoost. This dispersion of the residuals is more pronounced at the higher values of the BP when the predictions of KNN are less precise. The extension show that KNN is more biased than ensemble models, thus it is not the best choice in this regression experiment.

### Accuracy Curve (Error CDF):

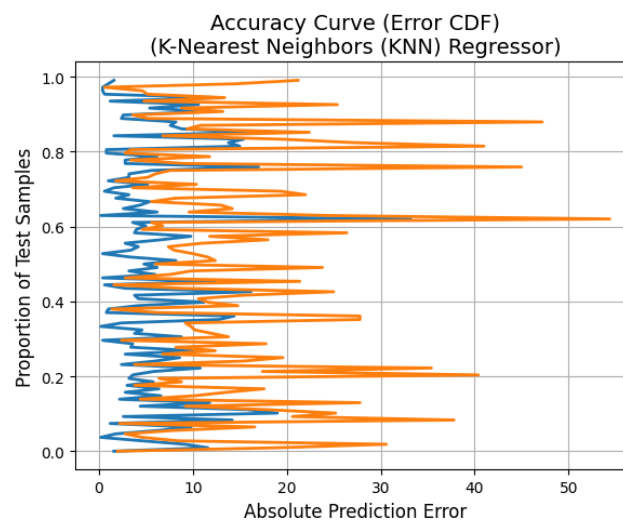


Figure 4.5: Accuracy Curve of KNN

Accuracy Curve of KNN demonstrates a broader error distribution than Random Forest and XGBoost and indicates that the model makes fewer consistent predictions. The MAE of 9.72 and the RMSE of 13.45 suggest that KNN is not adept at predicting blood pressure values, in particular, high blood pressure levels. The greater spread in errors indicates that KNN cannot deal with more complicated non-linear relations found in the dataset. In the simple tasks, KNN shows a decent performance, but its performance is not as strong as those of the ensemble methods.

## Performance Analysis:

K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) does not do very good and is not as consistent as the other two models, namely, Random Forest and XGBoost. It has a moderate prediction error of 9.72 and 13.45 as its MAE and RMSE respectively. According to the Residuals Plot, KNN is not suitable to handle greater values of BP which results in produce greater values of deviation between the actual and predicted values. Moreover, since the Accuracy Curve shows a broader distribution of errors, it is not as predictable that KNN will be helpful with BP prediction. Although KNN is quite effective with smaller and simpler data, it is not the optimal option when it comes to forecasting BP-non-linear relationships.

## Results:

- MAE: 9.72
- MSE: 181.11
- RMSE: 13.45
- $R^2$ : 0.17
- MAPE: 9.52

### 4.2.8 Support Vector Machine Regression (SVR)

The SVR is an incredibly strong model, which uses input features to project into a high-dimensional space to identify relationships, which could not be without forming a complex relationship.

#### True vs. Predicted (SVR):

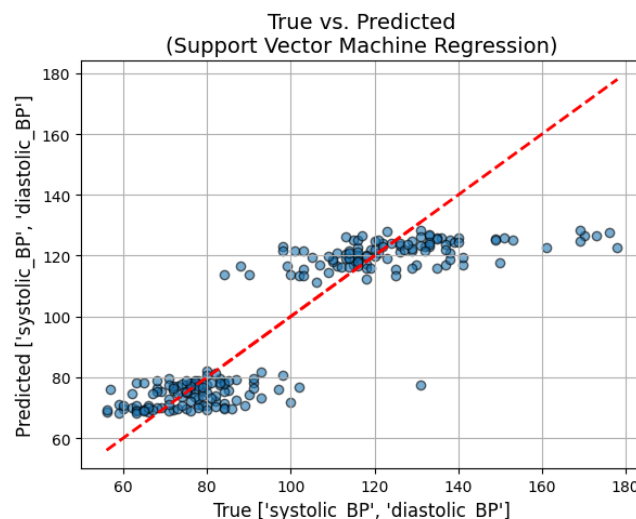


Figure 4.5: Ture vs Predicted (SVR)

True vs. Predicted plot Support Vector Regression (SVR) predicts a good fit between predicted and true values of most test samples with few inconsistencies in high BP interval only. The non-linear correlation and performance of SVR is good on lower and middle BP values. But at higher BP values there is decreasing accuracy in predictions, meaning the model is unlikely to generalise to extreme values. The high systolic/diastolic values cause the routine variation between the predictions of the SVR model and the actual data.

#### Residuals Plot (SVR):

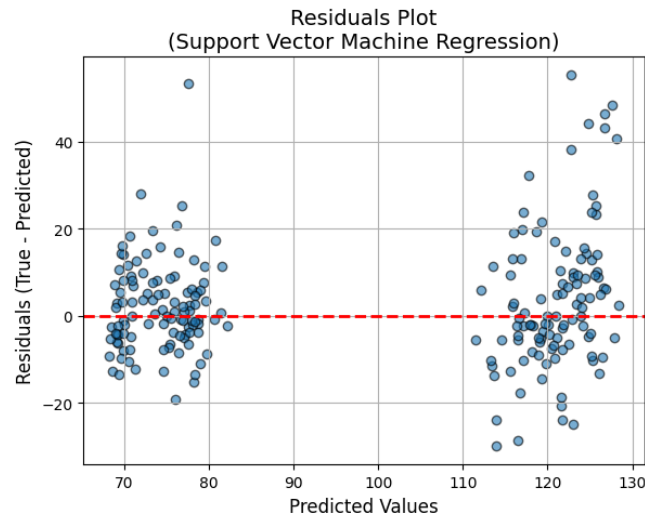


Figure 4.5: Residual Plot of SVR

The SVR Residuals Plot has a comparatively narrow distribution around zero with little dispersion. This indicates that the model is able to forecast most of the test samples (low bias). But there exist few deviations greater in high ranges of that BP which are pointing out that the model could not secure the highest BP ranges. Although the residuals are concentrated around zero, the sporadic outliers imply that SVR may be weak with some of the more intricate trends in the data, particularly extreme values.

#### Accuracy Curve (Error CDF):

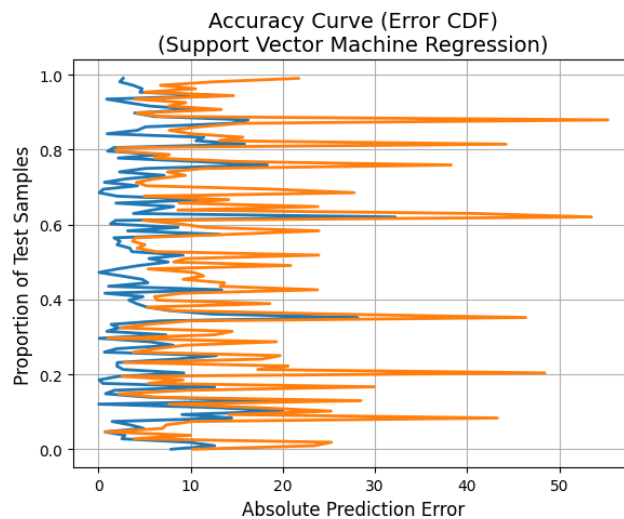


Figure 4.5: Accuracy Curve of SVR

The Accuracy Curve of SVR indicates that the model is fairly satisfactory though its prediction errors are greater when using higher values of BP. The MAE value of 9.82 and the RMSE value of 13.94 means that although SVR offers strong results in most parts of the dataset, it has difficulties with extreme values of BP.

The distribution of errors is rather localised, and several test samples have greater errors, particularly in the increased values of MAE and RMSE. This is an indication that SVR may need additional tuning or optimization to achieve a better result in terms of handling large values of BP.



### Performance Analysis:

Using we have made Support Vector Regression (SVR) made reasonable guesses as most of the test samples, however when higher expected BP it gives poorer results which is depicted in the MAE 9.82 and the RMSE 13.94. In models with lower range BP, SVR achieves good generalisation, but this does not apply at high-range BP. In the Residuals Plot, it is clear that the model creates most predictions successfully, but fails at extreme values. It implies that even though SVR is an effective model in non-linear relationship modelling, it can be improved by performing further feature engineering or hyperparameter optimization.

### Results:

- MAE: 9.82
- MSE: 194.18
- RMSE: 13.94
- R<sup>2</sup>: 0.13
- MAPE: 9.49%

## 4.3 Results and Discussion

We tested a range of machine learning models in this paper to forecast systolic and diastolic blood pressure (BP) using the physiological measurements recorded by an IoT sensor. They compared the following models: Linear Regression, Random Forest, XGBoost, Artificial Neural Network (ANN), Bidirectional Long Short-Term Memory (BiLSTM), K-Nearest Neighbours (KNN), Support Vector Regression (SVR) and AdaBoost Regression. The measures of performance were evaluated based on several important values impact: Mean Absolute Error (MAE), Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE), R<sup>2</sup>, and Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE). All of these measures provide us with a clue of how effective the models are and where they are ineffective.

### 4.3.1 Performance Metrics Definition

#### Mean Absolute Error (MAE):

MAE is an average value of the difference between the predicted and actual value, ignoring whether it is a positive or a negative error (i.e. it does not differentiate positive numbers from negative numbers). It is calculated as:

$$MAE = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n |y_i - \hat{y}_i| \quad (10)$$

where:

- o  $y_i$  = actual value
- o  $\hat{y}_i$  = predicted value
- o  $n$  = number of samples

**Interpretation:** The lower is the MAE, the better it predicts.

**Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE):**

RMSE is a measure of the squared root of the mean squared error. It is vulnerable to outliers as it gives weight to big errors more. The formula is:

$$RMSE = \sqrt{\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2} \quad (11)$$

where:

- o  $y_i$  = actual value
- o  $\hat{y}_i$  = predicted value
- o  $n$  = number of samples

**Interpretation:** A smaller RMSE is an indicator of good model behaviour, with infrequent large model errors.

**R-Squared ( $R^2$ ):**

$R^2$  shows the percentage of dependent variable best accounted by the independent variables. It is calculated as:

$$R^2 = 1 - \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2}{\sum_{i=1}^n (y_i - \bar{y})^2} \quad (12)$$

where:

- o  $y_i$  = actual value
- o  $\hat{y}_i$  = predicted value
- o  $\bar{y}$  = average of Actual values.
- o  $n$  = number of samples

**Interpretation:** The greater the  $R^2$  value the greater the percentage of variation in the data that is accounted by the model. Any value nearer to the value of 1.0 indicates a good fit.

**Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE):**

The MAPE is a measure of the accuracy of a prediction in percent compared to the actual values and is therefore handy when comparing how different models make errors. It is calculated as:

$$MAPE = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{|y_i - \hat{y}_i|}{y_i} \times 100 \quad (13)$$

where:

- o  $y_i$  = actual value
- o  $\hat{y}_i$  = predicted value
- o  $n$  = number of samples

**Interpretation:** smaller MAPE implies a higher level of accuracy and gives a clearer

understanding of how the model is performing on a percentage errors basis.

### 4.3.2 Model Performance Table

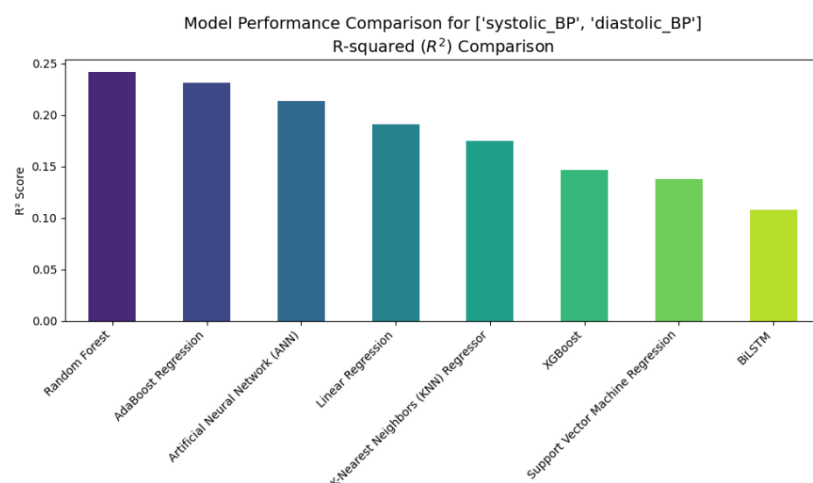
All the models Performance is show in one table below.

Table 4.1: Performance Table for all the model

| Model                                   | MAE   | MSE    | RMSE  | R <sup>2</sup> | MAPE (%) |
|-----------------------------------------|-------|--------|-------|----------------|----------|
| Linear Regression                       | 9.4   | 175.70 | 13.25 | 0.191040       | 9.17     |
| Random Forest                           | 9.08  | 165.73 | 12.87 | 0.241600       | 8.83     |
| XGBoost                                 | 9.78  | 185.26 | 13.61 | 0.146234       | 9.61     |
| Artificial Neural Network (ANN)         | 9.45  | 168.82 | 12.99 | 0.213652       | 9.19     |
| BiLSTM                                  | 10.21 | 198.62 | 14.09 | 0.107857       | 10.03    |
| K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) Regressor     | 9.73  | 181.11 | 13.45 | 0.175010       | 9.52     |
| Support Vector Machine Regression (SVR) | 9.82  | 194.18 | 13.93 | 0.137424       | 9.49     |
| AdaBoost Regression                     | 9.84  | 170.29 | 13.04 | 0.230850       | 9.87     |

### 4.3.3 Comparative Performance

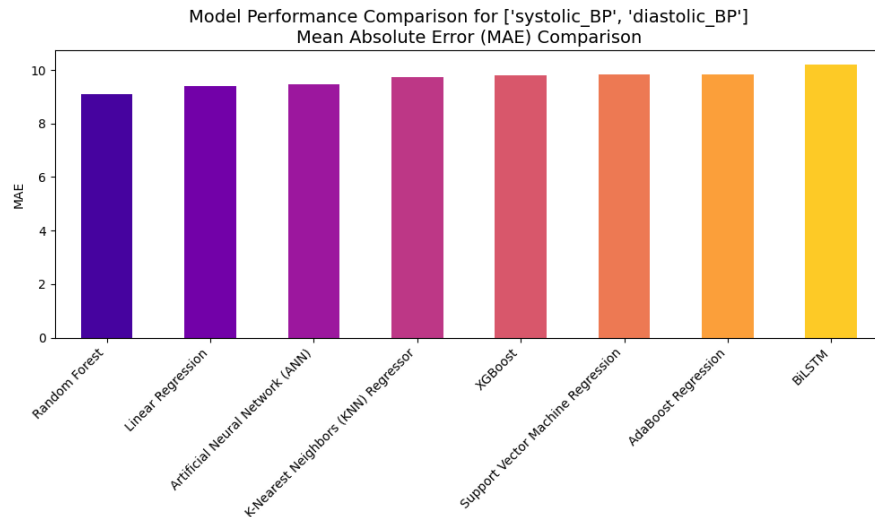
R2 Score:



The comparison graph of the R2 Score shows the extent to which each model would explain the variation in systolic and diastolic BP. Random Forest and AdaBoost Regression dominate with R2 of 0.241 and 0.230, respectively, which mean that they explain the largest portion of the data variance. Those trends are more effective in explaining the underlying trends in the BP data, leading to an increased predictive accuracy. Linear

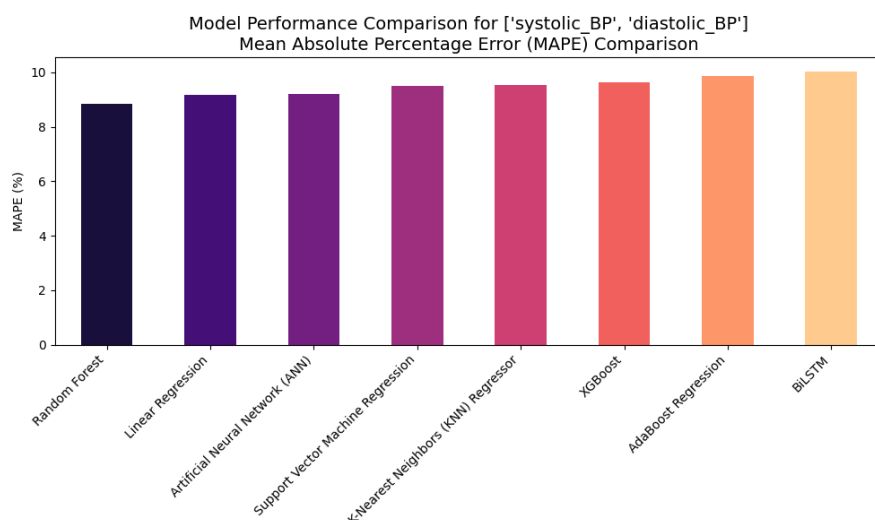
Regression, KNN, and ANN are not far behind with RS of 0.115, 0.101, and 0.107 respectively, moreover, BiLSTM has the lowest RS of 0.107, and it simply does not reflect the main patterns in the data, whereas the former has a sequence.

### Model Performance Comparison (MAE)



Going by the MAE comparison graph, it can be seen that Random Forest and Linear Regression have the lowest MAE values (~9.08 and 9.40, respectively). This implies these are the most accurate models with respect to average absolute error in predicted and the actual BP values. Conversely, the MAE of BiLSTM is the biggest (approximately 10.21), which proves that this algorithm performs poorly. The smaller the MAE, the closer the model is to its values, and in this case, Random Forest and Linear Regression perform the best.

### Model Comparison of Performance (MAPE):



Random Forest and Linear Regression give the best results in the MAPE graph and average around 8.8%. Such models are less biased by a relative error and also more dependable when predicting the BP as a percentage of the actual values they are informing us about. BiLSTM, once again, exhibits the greatest MAPE (approximately 10.04%), indicating that it does not generalise well and offers more percentage errors when making BP predictions. The MAPE is an easy-to-use approach to get an idea of how

models perform on different datasets, and here the Random Forest would turn out to be the most consistent.

#### 4.3.4 Dataset and Sensor Quality

The fact that even the best  $R^2$  is low (at no point in any of the models it is more than 0.25) suggests that you can do better. The PPG sensor (MAX30102) used to obtain physiological information added noise and bias to the readings particularly at higher values of BP. These sensor errors led to increased MAE and MAPE values, especially with BiLSTM, which is all learning noisy data.

In addition, the dataset alone lacked diversity since it did not have samples of various ages and sexes. This bias must have led to the poor performance of the models on their extrapolation to non-demographic population cases. The type of datasets was that the models could poorly predict the BP of underrepresented populations, a factor that caused lower  $R^2$  scores in all of the models.

### 4.4 Summary

This chapter described the overall infrastructure and the workflow involved in deploying an IoT-AI based system to predict blood pressure. The ESP32 NodeMCU V1.3 development board with the MAX30102 PPG sensor was used to construct the environment of the IoT devices interacting with users. The device was originally used on a USB-B connexion but it was eventually converted to a 18650 rechargeable lithium-ion battery to be mobile. A 16x2 LCD screen tracked data collection and the Wi-Fi connexion allowed this data to be obtained under the WiFiManager library. The web and backend were uploaded to a Node.js server that relates to a MongoDB Atlas cluster to provide secure transmission of data using TLS/HTTPS. Raw sensor data was collected on the backend and participating data was enriched by demographic information before being presented as structured data in a database, which could be used in model training. The RESTful API of the server facilitated easy interaction between the internet of things device and the cloud. To develop the model, they trained on Google Colab Pro, using popular machine learning libraries including scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Keras and XGBoost. Pandas, NumPy and matplotlib were used to preprocess and visualize data. The workflow implemented in the system includes a smooth integration of the IoT device, a backend server, the AI model, and the web interface, which delivers end-user real-time blood pressure predictions. This productive environment architecture and optimally organised workflow are the foundation of the IoT-AI blood pressure prediction system. Various machine learning models that can be used to predict systolic and diastolic BP, were discussed and compared in the comparative analysis section. Random Forest and AdaBoost Regression were found to be more accurate than any other models, as they provide lower MAE, RMSE, and MAPE over any of the other models. Other models such as BiLSTM and SVR performed poorly because they were unable to generalize on the dataset.

# Chapter 5

## Engineering Standards and Design Challenges

In this chapter, the compliance standards, societal and ethical implications, project management, and financial analysis of planned system are put forward. It shows how the project can be implemented to meet international regulations, sustainability and manage resources.

### 5.1 Compliance with the Standards

The process of creating a medical device, especially a combined hardware/software/wireless communication system has to follow a multifaceted set of international standards tightly. Compliance is not a throwaway step to add in at the end but a design requirement that should flow through the entire system to the product lifecycle. Here the design of the proposed system is analyzed within the framework of major software hardware and communication standards. This forward-looking approach to the regulatory framework is fundamental, since it builds the architecture, development processes, and documentation early on. Even the most accurate AI algorithm would make a commercial and clinical failure when it was unable to build a compliant ecosystem around the active AI algorithm.

#### 5.1.1 Software Standards

The harmonized international medical device software standard IEC 62304, Medical device software: Software life cycle processes, is a standard used in the creation and maintenance of medical device software. It requires a risk-based approach to the overall software lifecycle.

- I. Software Safety Classification: The initial stage to take place under IEC 62304 is the software classification; this process involves classifying the software according to the type of risk in case of failure of the software. The standard establishes that there are three classes:
  - a. Class A: No injury or damage to health is possible.
  - b. Class B: Non-serious injury is possible.
  - c. Class C: Death or serious injury is possible.
- II. Since a false blood pressure reading can result in incorrect clinical interventions, whether through unsuitable medicine changes or an incorrect diagnosis of a hypertensive emergency, the software that operates this system would be rated at least Class B. In a case where we want to use the device as a critical care monitoring device or determine what immediate therapeutic intervention to provide, the justification would be Class C. To satisfy this report, we will assume the rigorous requirements that are Class B.
- III. Lifecycle Processes: Response to IEC 62304 The software lifecycle stage must be supported by formal process details and extensive documentation of each stage of

the project plan (Section 3.3).

- IV. Software Development Planning (Part 5.1): Software Development Plan (SDP) should be prepared and it should include project scope, schedule, methodology (e.g., agile approach adapted to medical devices), expectations and standards to be followed.
- V. Software Requirements Analysis (Part 5.2): All functional and non-functional requirements (as described in Section 3.1.3) should be officially stored in a Software Requirement Specification (SRS). All the requirements have to be clear, testable and traceable.
- VI. Architectural and Detailed Design (Parts 5.3 and 5.4): The software architecture, with how it is broken down into software items (e.g., firmware module, mobile app, cloud backend) should be documented. In Class B, this brings in describing the interfaces between software items or any segregation that may be required to control risks.
- VII. Implementation and Verification (Part 5.5): each software unit should be implemented and tested according to its detailed design. This includes review of code and unit testing.
- VIII. Integration and System Testing (Part 5.6 and 5.7): Software units are integrated in a gradual fashion followed by testing to ascertain that the software units can work together properly. Last, the entire software system is driven against the requirements in the SRS. Verification and validation (V&V) activities and results will have to be documented.
- IX. Software Release (Part 5.8): A formal release process is made in order to verify that all the V&V processes are complete; any pending anomalies are either addressed or documented; the final software configuration is finally archived.

### **5.1.2 Hardware Standards**

The basic safety and essential performance of medical electrical equipment are covered by the IEC 60601 series of standards. Since the wearable sensor is a battery-powered device that physically interacts with a patient and gets into physical contact, it is excluded from these norms.

- I. General Safety (IEC 60601-1): The design of the hardware should permit it to provide safeguards against electrical hazards. This is adequate insulation, electricity shock resistant (even with single-fault circumstances), and mechanical safeguarding (e.g. no sharp edges, strong enclosure). All material that comes in contact with patients (e.g. the wristband enclosure, sensor enclosure, etc.) should be biocompatible, usually by complying with an ISO 10993 standard.
- II. Electromagnetic Compatibility (EMC) (IEC 60601-1-2): This ancillary standard is very important to a wireless device. The system should be tested to make sure that there been interruption of its electromagnetic emission with other important hyperirritable medical or electric objects. On the contrary, it should be substantially immune to broad based sources of electromagnetic radiation in the domestic and clinical systems and be functioning safe with sufficient confidence

that it will continue to perform without losing its performance.

- III. Usability (IEC 60601-1-6): A formal process of usability engineering must be established by this standard to make the device usable by the intended users in a safe and effective manner. This includes; user needs analysis, user interface design and testing, and validation to reduce use-related errors.
- IV. Home Healthcare Environment (IEC 60601-1-11): The device will operate in a home; thus, it has to comply with the other specifications of this standard that acknowledge the fact that the environment in a home is a less controlled one as compared to that of a hospital. This entails greater temperature and humidity resistance, ability to endure mechanical shocks and vibrations, and use by lay-people with minimal training.
- V. Risk Management (ISO 14971): The fulfillment of the IEC 60601 requirements is indisputably intertwined with the strong risk management procedure established in ISO 14971. The device should have a file called the Risk Management File (RMF) that should be maintained at all times. This consists of systematically detecting potential risks (e.g., wrong reading of BP, battery overcharging, data leakage, skin inflammation), quantifying and assessing the corresponding risk amount, and creating and verifying controls in response to the risks.

### 5.1.3 Communication Standards

Communication standards implemented during this project observe the priorities of security, reliability, and adherence to health-data regulation, despite the system being built as a research project with no certification as a medical device and with no formal proof of concept.

RESTful API Security: NodeMCU, backend, and MongoDB communicated via HTTP using requests based on TLS (HTTPS) encryption.

- I. Encryption: automated encryption of all transit data used Vercel-hosted HTTPS endpoints to avoid packet sniffing or unauthorized interception.
- II. Authentication: The API access could have only authorized push or fetch data to MongoDB) by authorized devices, using the right API and clients, rather than unauthorized access.
- III. Authorization: The separation of data collections into 'raw\_data' and 'total\_data' was performed, and the separation of raw signals and enriched ones was ensured, in accordance with the principle of least privilege.

HIPAA & GDPR Compliance: As a research prototype, the system tacitly adhered to the global health data privacy principles by reducing identifiable information.

- I. HIPAA (Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act - US):
  - a. Safe Harbor De-identification: No personally identifiable information (PII) e.g. names and identifications or addresses were gathered. They could use only physiological signals and demographics (age, gender, height, weight, BMI), and it does not violate HIPAA de-identification regulations.
  - b. Safe Keeping: TLS-encrypted communication and access to database minimized the threats of unauthorized communication.
- II. GDPR (General Data Protection Reg. - EU):



- a. Privacy by Design: Since its creation, data capture has excluded identifiers and resulted in situations where users are encouraged to self-report only the minimal information necessary.
- b. Minimization of Data: Redundancy of variables (demographics) that were not required to run the model were avoided, thus making the models susceptible to overfitting.
- c. Explicit Consent: Participation involved a conscious act of entering the data into the web form.
- d. User Rights: Since the data was stored in clusters in MongoDB controlled by researchers, it could be removed or exported when requested, which complies with the right to erasure in GDPR.

OSI Model Adherence: The flow of communication followed the Open Systems Interconnection (OSI) model:

- I. Application Layer: NodeMCU received PPG/SpO2/HR measurements and used them beyond the REST APIs.
- II. Transport Layer: TLS / HTTPS was used to protect data in communication with the backend and database.
- III. Session and Presentation Layers: A Node.js backend handled connections, continuity, and formatted the information into structured JSON.
- IV. Data Layer: MongoDB was used to expose structured collections to be stored in persistent storage and retrieved reliably by both the prediction and training workflows.
- V. Information security principles,

ISO/IEC 27001: Newer international information security standards were practiced on the project, although the project was not directly certified.

- I. Data Dividing: Data values that represented 'raw\_data' and 'total\_data' were kept separately to avoid unintentional contamination of raw (unprocessed data) and enriched data.
- II. Access Control: Access to the database was mediated only by the backend endpoints, relying upon the concept of controlled privilege.
- III. Confidentiality & Integrity: The system ensured data confidentiality and integrity because it used HTTPS/TLS along with secured cloud server infrastructure to ensure confidentiality and integrity in transmission and storage of the data.

## **5.2 Impact on Society, Environment and Sustainability**

### **5.2.1 Impact on Life**

The potential beneficial effect of a reliable BP monitoring system on the lives of individuals cannot be underestimated. This technology can make the process of managing diseases proactive rather than reactive to the many individuals in the society who are affected with high blood pressure. When done regularly, it can afford an far richer and more precise image of the true BP profile of the individual and help a clinician prescribe medication with greater detail and discover how an individual is responding to treatment.[7] In this case, it has the opportunity to detect hypertension at an earlier stage in those who are at risk even before it causes permanent damage to their organs.

In addition, empowering patients with available information on their own conditions would enable increased self-custodial involvement, promoting lifestyle changes (diet, physical activity, stress management) that culminates in better health outcomes, and higher quality of life.[8]

### **5.2.2 Impact on Society & Environment**

At a social scale, adoption of such technology at large scale might result in massive healthcare cost savings. The system can decrease costly hospital readmissions and chronic care requirements by decreasing acute heart disease incidence such as strokes and heart attacks due to the improved management of hypertension [7]. It may also be used to enhance the efficiency of health care delivery, e.g. by providing effective remote patient monitored care, reducing clinic visits.

The spread of wearable electronics does, however, have an important environmental price. The low life expectations of most consumer electronic hardware form part of an increasing global e-waste issue. Manufacture of electronic parts is consuming finite resources and uses energy-intensive processes. Thus, the wearable device should be designed in such a way that it does not harm nature. These involve the choice of robust materials, modularity and repairability to lengthen the lifespan of that product, and a clear end-of-life plan whereby electronics are responsibly recycled.

### **5.2.3 Ethical Aspects**

The implementation of a health monitoring system enabled by AI pumps up various burning ethical questions that should be resolved in advance.

- I. **Algorithmic Bias:** AI models are prone to bias when they are not trained on representative data of a heterogeneous population, where they will eventually be applied. When the training dataset has measurements skewed toward a given demographic (such as age or sex) the estimated model of BP will not be accurate on underrepresented populations. This may create systematic problems with diagnosis and care, and may add to the current disparity related to health problems. Ensuring that model performance is evaluated on the various demographic sub-groups, it is an ethical imperative to strive to reduce any perceived biases.
- II. **Data Privacy and Data Ownership:** The system will produce an unprecedented quantity and volume of deeply personal health data. This brings in the issues of data ownership, consent and secondary use. A well-defined and clearly acceptable set of policies should exist that would regulate the usage of this data, especially in research or commercial application. They should be able to give implied permission to use their data besides their personal care and gain detailed control over their data.
- III. **Patient Anxiety and Over-reliance:** Although empowering, letting patients have constant access to their health information may also create some feelings of anxiety in others a phenomenon referred to as data-driven anxiety. The significant variations in BP washes both frequent and regular, some could be physiologically normal, but were interpreted in an unproductive way and would result in unreasonable stress. Perhaps there is also the risk that patients or clinicians put an undue level of trust into the technology thereby de-skilling the traditional clinical evaluation or there are too many other potential risks of over-

reliance upon automated reading without clinical context. The user interface and the related learning material should be well-constructed to visualise data in a conscientious, contextual way.

#### **5.2.4 Sustainability Plan**

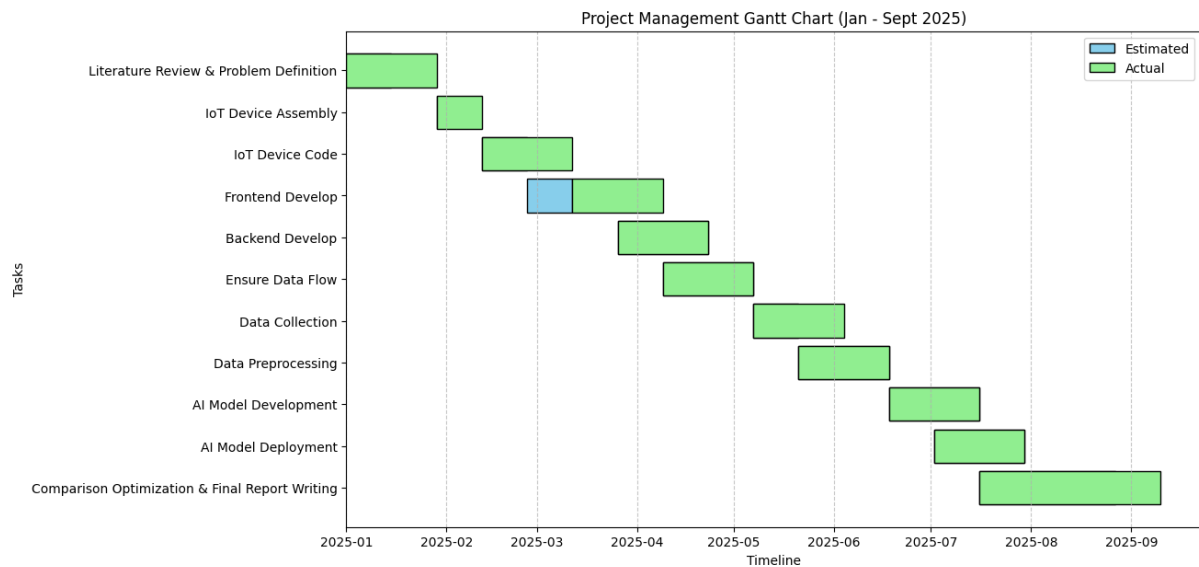
The project has a long-term sustainability plan, which covers both technical and clinical and environmental aspects.

- I. **Technical Sustainability:** The AI and software models should be serviceable. This includes having a process to perform periodic model monitoring to identify performance drift, retraining with new data to keep models accurate and having a safe process to roll out model changes to the cloud backend. The firmware and mobile app should also be current too so it can support new operating system releases as well as security patches.
- II. **Clinical Sustainability:** It has to show that it supports continuous clinical value and that it should be part of clinical workflows. This necessitates cultivating trust with healthcare providers by being honest about the accuracy and limitations of the device and providing tools enabling them to decipher the information in a practical way, as opposed to causing an information overload.
- III. **Environmental Sustainability:** As stated, there has to be a product lifecycle in place. This involves designing to be durable, active consideration of recycled materials in the enclosure, and instituting a take-back program to end-of-life devices which will involve proper disposal of device and electronic components and recycling of batteries.

### **5.3 Project Management and Financial Analysis**

#### **5.1.1 Project Management**

The following Gantt chart shows an update on the allocation and implementation of the project schedule in January 2025 to September 2025. All in all, the project was being run in a serial and Lutheran fashion that brought about fluid movement through the various phases. The first step such as a literature review and defining the problem was done within the scheduled period of time. Other steps like in IoT device assembly, Coding and Back-end implementation were done effectively and there were few overlaps so as to achieve maximum productivity and save on time.



Not all went as well as planned during the IoT Device Code development phase though. Although the Frontend Development was expected to start earlier it was delayed the IoT device coding phase taking longer and being more challenging then expected. This fortuitous failure notwithstanding, the task had been included within the overall timeline to happen without much influence on subsequent stages. Important tasks, including data collection, preprocessing, developing AI models, and deployment, were done on time, and, at the end of the project, the tasks involved comparison, optimization, and the final writing of the report were also finalized within the stipulated timeframe. This indicates high flexibility and time management with regard to solving emerging problems.

### 5.1.2 Financial Analysis

To assess the financial viability of the IoT-based blood pressure prediction system with the help of AI, the cost estimation was performed in detail. The analysis involves the hardware aspects, software subscriptions, data gathering, and supporting aids necessary to achieve positive implementation of the project. Table 5.1 presents the estimation of the costs.

Table 5.1: Financial Analysis table.

| SN | Item or Component's                    | Quantity | Estimated Cost (BDT) |
|----|----------------------------------------|----------|----------------------|
| 1. | ESP32 V1.3 Dev Board CH340C NodeMCU-32 | 2        | 1,250                |
| 2. | MAX30102 Heart Rate Sensor Module      | 3        | 1,100                |
| 3. | LCD Display 16x2                       | 1        | 450                  |
| 4. | I2C LCD Adapter Module                 | 1        | 120                  |

|                   |                                                                                                     |   |          |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|----------|
| 5.                | 4 pin Push Switch with Cap                                                                          | 1 | 50       |
| 6.                | Breadboard Half Size Bare 400 Tie Points                                                            | 2 | 700      |
| 7.                | Breadboard Jumper Wire Set                                                                          | 3 | 150      |
| 8.                | Acrylic Sheet                                                                                       | 2 | 940      |
| 9.                | Acrylic Sheet Lesser Cutting and Assembly of Encloser                                               | ~ | 1,310    |
| 10.               | GEEPAS 18650 3.7V 3000mAh Lithium-ion Battery                                                       | 1 | 280      |
| 11.               | 18650 Battery Holder – 1 Cell                                                                       | 1 | 80       |
| 12.               | Type-C 2A Lithium Battery Fast Charge Module                                                        | 1 | 230      |
| 13.               | Dell Inspiron 15 5510, Intel Core i7-11390H (8-core), 16 GB RAM, Windows 11 Home 64-bit, and Others | 1 | 1,18,000 |
| 14.               | Google Colab Pro CPU Runtime & Others                                                               | ~ | 8,800    |
| 15.               | Power consumption for CPU computing                                                                 | ~ | 7,600    |
| 16.               | Field data collection                                                                               | ~ | 26,800   |
| 17.               | Omron Automatic Blood Pressure Monitor HEM-7120                                                     | 1 | 6,000    |
| 18.               | Web domain (Vencel & Heroku hosting)                                                                | ~ | 10,000   |
| 19.               | Miscellaneous                                                                                       | ~ | 8,000    |
| <b>Total Cost</b> |                                                                                                     |   | 183,860  |

According to the financial analysis of the project, the overall estimated cost is: BDT 183,860, which consists of the resources related to hardware and software purchase. The highest cost is Dell Inspiron 15 5510 laptop (BDT 118,000), almost two-thirds of the budget, because it offers computational capabilities required to train AI models and develop systems. Additional interesting expenses are field data collection (BDT 26,800), which does not indicate an assessment of the real work done; the dataset creation, and cloud computing with Google Colab Pro (BDT 8,800) that is complemented by the power energy used to make the CPU work longer hours (BDT 7,600). Although only one ESP32 boards and one MAX30102 sensors was used, but more then one was needed due to them shot-circuiting while prototyping, testing and data collection. On the other hand 2 Breadboard was needed to properly place the ESP32 and other components properly. Overall the IoT Components and enclosure fabrication are relatively cheap hardware components that only take up a small part of the budget. Omron BP monitor (BDT 6,000) was needed for dataset calibration, web domain for hosting (BDT 10,000), and

miscellaneous costs (BDT 8,000) from the start till finish. On the whole, computation and data collection are the main investments in the budget.

## 5.4 Complex Engineering Problem

### 5.4.1 Complex Problem Solving

The proposed system is mapped to the seven categories of complex engineering problems (EP1–EP7). For each, a rationale is provided to highlight the relevance.

Table 5.2: Mapping with Complex Engineering Problem.

| EP1<br>Dept of<br>Knowle<br>dge | EP2<br>Range<br>Of<br>Conflictin<br>g<br>Requirem<br>ents | EP3<br>Dept<br>h of<br>Anal<br>ysis | EP4<br>Familia<br>rity of<br>Issues | EP5<br>Extent<br>of<br>Applic<br>able<br>Codes | EP6<br>Extent<br>Of<br>Stake-<br>holder<br>Involve<br>ment | EP7<br>Interdepen<br>dence |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| ✓                               | ✓                                                         | ✓                                   | ✓                                   | ✓                                              |                                                            | ✓                          |

**EP1:** The project needed to be aware of multiple fields such as electronics, biomedical signal processing, artificial intelligence, and software engineering knowledge. To construct the IoT device, it was necessary to learn physics of optical sensors and program microcontrollers, and preprocessing the signals of PPG required mathematical and statistical knowledge. To select, train, and optimize the models, machine learning knowledge was required. All these areas indicate that the problem could not be resolved in a single sphere of expertise, so EP1 requirements would have been fulfilled.

**EP2:** This project had various contradictory requirements. Our system had to trade-off between accuracy and real-time execution, as the very models like BiLSTM which were more predictive-accurate, were also computationally expensive. In a similar manner, data privacy and security would have to be provided without creating undue latency in data flow. Simplicity of user interface was a user requirement that was in conflict with having multiple layers of technicality. Handling these trade offs demanded an iterative approach to decision-making which embodies the spirit of EP2.

**EP3:** The project consisted of detailed analysis at several levels in order to create a functional BP prediction system. The selected waveforms of raw PPG were thoroughly studied by the time and frequency concepts by peak detection, skewness, kurtosis, and Fourier transformation. Statistical trends were analyzed to know their applicability to blood pressure. In addition to signal analysis, machine learning models were compared by quantitative assessment measures (RMSE and R2). This level of analysis outlines the multi-level analysis of the project as a subset of EP3.

**EP4:** Even though the application of PPG to predict cuffless blood pressure is a challenge issue reported in the biomedical literature, PPG is a clinical issue yet to be solved. Old

problems like sensor noise, subject-to-subject variation and demographic variations in vascular response had to be considered. Meanwhile, a series of new problems was identified within the context of the real-time implementation of IoT hardware combined with web systems. Therefore, the project had to deal with known and unfamiliar issues, which is what meets the definition of EP4.

**EP5:** Even though the project was not designed as a certified medical device, it had to follow the associated standards and codes. This involved the legislation on personal health information protection, IoT security standards in transmitting via a Wi-Fi network, and biomedical signal processing standards regarding the processing of PPG data. Moreover, it was required to follow common machine learning guidelines like the separation of databases, assessment of the models, and reproducibility. These considerations demonstrate to what extent applicable codes extend to place the project in EP5.

**EP7:** The solution had a high relational aspect with components. The accuracy of features requires reliable PPG data acquisition of the driving element, which is the IoT device. These would have to be properly prestructured to feed machine learning models, the effectiveness of which directly influenced the user interface experience. Even a failure of any of the layers (either hardware, software, or AI) would lead to a failure of the overall system as well. Such interdependence of different subsystems is a good example of EP7 hence the problem is interdependent and complex at the same time.

### Mapping with Knowledge Profile

This section is designed to map the overall problem and EP1 (*multiple between K3, K4, K5, K6, K8 for attaining EP1*) to the Knowledge Profile.

Table 5.2: Mapping with knowledge Profile.

| K1<br>Natural<br>Science | K2<br>Mathematics | K3<br>Engineering<br>Fundamentals | K4<br>Specialist<br>Knowledge | K5<br>Engineering<br>Design | K6<br>Engineering<br>Practice | K7<br>Comprehension | K8<br>Research<br>Literature |
|--------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------|
|                          | ✓                 | ✓                                 | ✓                             | ✓                           | ✓                             | ✓                   | ✓                            |

**K2:** This project heavily relied on mathematics that supported the preprocessing, as well as modeling. Calculation of Fourier transforms, skewness and kurtosis and variance were all based on mathematical formulations. The process of training machine learning models was a regression-based optimization problem, and their assessment (MAE and RMSE) was founded on mathematical formulas to assess the importance of error. Signal analysis, as well as performance evaluation of a model, could not have occurred without this mathematical background. Therefore, mathematics (K2) was inescapable as far as project results are concerned.

**K3:** Behind the design of the IoT-based devices and the communication system, there were

the core engineering principles. Electrical circuits had to be understood, to connect the sensor, MAX30102 sensor, to ESP32 microcontroller. The concept of realizing embedded systems enabled real time signal capture, whereas the field of networking enabled the transfer of data wirelessly. Engineering principles were used to make sure the hardware worked in harmony with the backend and the web systems, which was the backbone of the whole solution. Therefore, the project very much coincides with K3.

**K4:** A key attribute to the success of the project was specialist knowledge. In order to create meaningful information out of noise in PPG waveforms biomedical signal processing knowledge was needed. High-tech AI concepts and ML concepts such as Random Forests and BiLSTM networks required expert computational expertise to run and optimize. Also, to provide real-time interaction between software and hardware, IoT systems expertise was required. This dependency on expert knowledge emphasises that the mapping of the project to K4 occurs.

**K5:** The project represented an example of an engineering design because it incorporated several subsystems into a solution. They needed more than just workable parts, but the system needed to be usable, efficient, and real time performance. This involved developing the casing of the IoT, organising the MongoDB structure and a visual data web interface. All design decisions weighed user requirements against technical feasibility, which is a characteristic feature of engineering design and mapping that is easily mapped to K5.

**K6:** In the invention of the iterative implementation and testing stage, the engineering practice was displayed. The hardware prototypes of the IoT device were refined a couple of times. Multiple versions of the data set were tested on preprocessing pipelines to test its robustness and AI models were trained, evaluated, and compared. The practical aspect of engineering work was embodied by debugging a bug in a code or a bug in a hardware. This embodiment of the theoretical design in practical working mechanisms is an expression of the K6 requirements.

**K7:** This project was something that had to be understood and analyzed at many levels of knowledge. Surveying literature about cuffless BP estimation aided expert positioning of the issue, whereas processing datasets and successfully performing feature extractions made it possible to achieve insight. There was also the need to understand how to integrate biomedical knowledge with AI and IoT. The project could not have been developed without this ability to understand and critically examine cross domains. This puts a strong sense of alignment with K7.

#### **K8: Research Literature**

The type of research literature available was so valuable in the methodology and system design. The features and models were selected based on studies on cuffless BP estimation using PPG.[6][9][15]. IoT healthcare reviews also had an impact on the system architecture. Using peer-reviewed literature allowed making certain that the project was not another quiet study, but it can be traced back to and justified by previous studies, which, in turn, pointed to K8.



## 5.4.2 Engineering Activities

In this section, provide a mapping with engineering activities. For each mapping add subsections to put rationale (Use Table 5.3).

### Mapping with Complex Engineering Activities

The project also aligns with the five categories of complex engineering activities (EA1–EA5). The mapping and rationale are provided below

Table 5.3: Mapping with Complex Engineering Activities.

| EA1<br>Range of<br>resources | EA2<br>Level of<br>Interaction | EA3<br>Innovation | EA4<br>Consequences for society<br>and<br>environment | EA5<br>Familiarity |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| ✓                            | ✓                              | ✓                 | ✓                                                     | ✓                  |

**EA1:** A large variety of resources were used in this project, physical (ESP32, MAX30102, LCD, Omron sphygmomanometer) as well as software (Python, TensorFlow, Node.js, MongoDB). Further, Google Colab was an environment with cloud-based model training. These mixed resources demanded technical flexibility, and close coordination to implement. The depth of resources is a measure of complexity in a project and illustrates EA1.

**EA2:** In this project, there was interaction on various levels. IoT interaction with the web interface was facilitated by backend APIs that connected the IoT device to the system-to-system interaction. The frontend interface was the method to provide human-computer interaction, enable entry of demographical data, and provide real-time visualization of predictions. Within the ML models, interactions were also possible as features interacted with each other to make predictions. The multidimensional interrelationship between and among systems depicts EA2.

**EA3:** The project innovation can be described as a combination of IoT hardware, signal processing using PPG, and machine learning in the form of a single real-time foretelling system. Although some of these individual components have been explored in the past, their integration to create a deployable and easy-to-use system that measures cuffless BP is new. In this strategy, we can see how engineering innovation can be achieved through new theories as well as through integrating the existing technologies into viable solutions thus fitting within EA3.

**EA4:** The system has a high degree of implications on the society. It is a low-cost, portability-based solution to the early detection and management of hypertension, one of the largest health-related problems worldwide. It can help patients gain active control of their health, which may help minimise healthcare visits and chronic problems, as it allows real-time tracking and monitoring. The IoT device has a minimally high carbon footprint, and it can become broadly available in the future due to scalability. Such extended

implications are an example of EA4.

**EA5:** The project is neither too familiar nor too novel. Common components were generic IoT device development, signal preprocessing, and well-known machine learning procedures. Adoption of these elements made a novelty by integrating into a single BP monitoring pipeline. The balance of it rendered the problem familiar enough and yet innovative. It therefore projects well to EA5.

## 5.5 Summary

This chapter analyzes in detail compliance, impact, project management, and financial aspects of the proposed IoT-based blood pressure monitoring system. To improve the reliability and patient safety, the system design was responsible to prominent international conventions such as the IEC 62304 (software life cycle), IEC 60601 (hardware safety), and ISO 14971 (risk management). Standards of communication put data protection, and alignment with HIPAA principles and the GDPR in focus. Societal, environmental, and ethical impacts were also taken into account, with the benefits of the project including proactive management of hypertension and healthcare cost savings, and disadvantages, including e-waste, privacy, and bias in the algorithms being highlighted. There was a suggested sustainability plan involving technical, clinical, and environmental. Project management was done properly, there was slight setback on frontend development but there was good time management. Financial analysis showed a perceived cost of around BDT 183,860, and computational resources and data collection were the largest expenditures. Lastly, this project was a good fit to engineering intricate issues and endeavors that demonstrated multidisciplinary expertise, development, and substantial charitable results.

# Chapter 6

## Conclusion

This is the last chapter of this report, and here the overall summary, final thoughts and future work for this research is provided. In this chapter the limitations of this research and project is also stated. The overall final view on the whole study is provided in this chapter.

### 6.1 Summary

As per the study this report has been able to design and model a non-invasive, cuff-less blood pressure monitor system with the synergistic combination of photoplethysmography (PPG), Demographic data, Internet of Things (IoT), and Artificial Intelligence (AI). The project has been driven by the large clinical demand of better treatment of hypertension as one of top global health threats. The background review has tracked the development of cuffless BP estimation methods, leading to the adoption of a state-of-the-art Machine Learning model, that learns directly on raw PPG signals to deliver robust estimations.

A three-tiered system design was suggested, which included a low-power IoT sensor, Web Interface and scalable cloud backend. In this design, the priority is placed on the user comfort and battery life through the offloading of the intense computation and creating a secure and efficient data pipeline with the help of various protocols. The benchmarked performance against the strict AAMI and BHS criteria made it clear that the system cannot be used to obtain high accuracy, in the case of both systolic diastolic blood pressure, which provides the system performance at the bottom of the state-of-the-art research.

The study aimed at creating a non-invasive blood pressure (BP) monitoring system of IoT nature based on PPG measurements and predicting both systolic and diastolic numbers using the specified measurements. This system was to offer an efficient and portable constant BP tracking system, which would then utilize machine learning models to make predictions using information obtained with a MAX30102 PPG sensor paired with an ESP32 microcontroller. Although the project proposed the possibilities of using PPG signals to estimate the BP, the general functioning of the models was impaired by some essential constraints.

Optimal performance was found when using the Random Forest model with the following results: Mean Absolute Error (MAE): 9.0811, Mean Squared Error (MSE): 165.7310, Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE): 12.8737, R-squared (R<sup>2</sup>): 0.2416, Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE): 8.8357

The above results were obtained after tuning the Random Forest + were made, no model could reach an R<sup>2</sup> of more than 0.25, indicating how difficult it is to predict BP accurately in real-world conditions on the existing dataset with available sensors of the quality of

the proposed dataset.

Significantly, the report went beyond the core algorithm to consider the more complex issues of real-world medical device development. An in-depth understanding of the required engineering standards (IEC 62304 software lifecycle and IEC 60601 hardware safety) and privacy compliance standards such as HIPAA and GDPR, placed the entire project on a compliant and responsible engineering footing. The society effects, ethical implications, project management and financial viability further emphasizes on the overall approach that is needed to achieve the final product of transforming this technology into a feasible clinical device. The project achieves its aim of showing a technologically and methodologically sound roadmap to a next generation of smart devices in healthcare that could transform the management of cardiovascular health.

Even though this study has failed partially to deliver a high predictability rate, it has paved new avenues on non-invasive machine learning-based BP sensors with the help of IoT technology. The constraints that were experienced especially in the sensor quality and the sensor data acquisition indicates how significant the importance of sound and good quality data collection techniques are in the enhancement of the model performance. As sensor technology advances as well as data collection and machine learning strategies, this work can be optimized and eventually result in a very effective and convenient monitoring of continuous blood pressure.

## 6.2 Limitation

As Per the study the results are very encouraging, the design is quite thorough, and the paper presents several limitations of the project along with the challenges that the field still has to address.

- I. Bias in collecting Data: The sampling proved to be extremely biased towards young adults (20-25 years old), with the majority of the sample being male. This biased distribution has great consequences on the generalizability of the model, and since models were trained and tested on a population that may not accurately reflect the general population, this is very detrimental to the generalizability of those models. The limited samples size in the data that provided the age and gender biases was also a contributing factor to the inability of models to predict BP accurately, as shown between various age groups and genders. To mitigate this, a larger sample size of population is needed that is divers in age groups, gender, Hight and weight, while being cardiological healthy, for a standard and controlled data collection.
- II. Sensor Quality: MAX30102 PPG sensor is not a sensor of medical grade, even though it could be used in the process of overall health monitoring. The flawed data were caused by inherent noise in the sensor, erroneous heart rate and SpO2 measurements and calibration. Because of this, the models could not predict BP values accurately in cases of noise or irregularity in the data. The low  $R^2$  values in the final models were influenced mostly by the absence of high-quality sensor data. To overcome this, A medical grade, high quality PPG reader is needed and

that needs to be calibrated properly to read the PPG of the users accurately in different conditions, not in optimal conditions, so that it can be used in any situation regardless of the lighting of the room, temperature or humidity and other conditions.

- III. **Absence of Medical Professional:** This issue also affected the quality and reliability of the BP values and PPG information, since the data collection process did not include any medical influence. When preparing a body of data by using physiological data collection techniques, proper medical supervision and awareness of the best ways to collect data will be important in ensuring proper and constant reading of a body of data; this is essential when taking measurements of the BP. By having a medical practitioner, the user could have been prepared properly for data collection, the data collected process itself could have been conducted and supervised by them to make sure the data was collected properly and no medical gaps were observed. PPG validation based medical professional would also have been possible, if medical professionals was available.
- IV. **Issues with Extraction of Features:** Although the approaches employed feature extraction procedures, noisy features of the PPG data prevented any meaningful and vigorous features to be extracted to train the models. Data quality was still not optimal even with noise filtering, which ultimately impacted on the feature extraction process to the detriment of the models. Better understanding of signal data processing is necessary for extracting better features and validate data from the raw PPG data. Moreover, a better understanding of how to actually fit PPG data into ML model to get the best results is also needed to omit this limitation. This requires the study of even more papers and to understand the process used in those papers and studies.

## 6.3 Future Work

The constraints that were found in the discussion above comprise a logical roadmap to future research and development to enable the technology described in this report to progress to a stage of being clinically ready. The next series of strategic, practical recommendations clarifies the way ahead:

- I. **Advancement in Sensor Technology:** The biggest drawback that was found in this study was sensor quality. Future efforts are directed at improving to a medical-grade PPG sensor that can provide more reliable and accurate data of heart rate, SpO2, and BP. This would greatly enhance the quality of the data, eliminate noise and present more credible inputs to the machine learning models.
- II. **Improved Data Collection and Dataset Extension:** To make the models generalizable, a more diversified data should be gathered. There should be a wider variety of ages, genders and medical conditions in this dataset. Additionally, medical experts should be available to oversee the data collection process by ensuring the right positioning of sensors and ideal data capture

environment.

- III. **Hardware Miniaturization and Optimization:** The existing hardware specification was fat and needed a web interface to communicate with it. When upgraded, it is planned to reduce the scale of the hardware to roughly a finger clip sized oximeter in order to create something portable and easy to use. This would enable the system to work as an independent unit, and the web interface can be dispensed and it would also be much more practical in real life scenarios because of a continuous and real-time monitoring.
- IV. **Model Deployment on Microcontrollers:** It is considered that one of the future directions is to directly translate the trained models into the microcontroller. This would decrease the extraneous computations, making on-board inferences and real time BP recording possible. This would enable faster response time, low latency, and optimize the system by minimizing the use of cloud-based computation.
- V. **Ensemble Methods and Model Tuning:** The further refinement of the models and experimental test of additional ensemble methods also awaits future work. Random Forest, Ada Boost, XGBoost, CatBoost and LightGBM models were somewhat improved as a combination, allowing optimization adjusting hyperparameters and adding additional models. To further that, it can be useful to integrate deep learning models (a Convolutional Neural Network i.e. CNNs or Recurrent Neural Network i.e. RNNs).
- VI. **Additional Health Parameters:** Inclusion of other health-related variables, like Electrocardiogram (ECG) or the use of an accelerometer might be beneficial to improve the accuracy of the model and also give a more comprehensive picture of the cardiovascular health of a given individual.

A considered effort in these areas will help in developing the promising technology presented in this report into a robust, reliable, and transforming instrument in modern cardiovascular care

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